

FEWER HURDLES, EASIER BUSINESS IN DELHI **P3**



KUKI MLAs RETURN TO MANIPUR ASSEMBLY AFTER 3 YEARS OF CONFLICT **P5**

'WANT FILMS LIKE THIS IN MY FILMOGRAPHY' **P12**



ESCALATION PUTS STRAIT OF HORMUZ BACK IN FOCUS

US and Iran trade strikes as Middle East tensions surge

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Dubai, September 2

The United States launched fresh strikes on targets in Iran on Tuesday, triggering a new round of missile and drone attacks by Tehran and raising tensions across the Middle East after a month-long lull in major military action. The latest exchange also left civilians dead in southern Iran, with Iranian officials saying a US missile struck a house hosting a wedding in Sirik county, killing four people, including two children, and injuring 67 others. The Iranian Red Crescent Society reported the casualties, while Iran's foreign ministry described the strike as a "war crime."

US Central Command said the strikes followed Iranian attempts to attack commercial shipping in the Strait of Hormuz and US service members in the region. Tehran responded with missile and drone attacks against American



targets in Kuwait, Jordan, Iraq and Bahrain, according to Iranian reports. The latest confrontation marked a significant escalation compared with exchanges over the weekend.

Central Command said it was looking into Iranian media reports about the strike on the wedding gathering, while maintaining that "the US military never targets civilians,

unlike the IRGC". US President Donald Trump warned Iran against further retaliation, saying in a social media post that any response would be met with attacks "at a

much harder and higher level". He added that the biggest attack was "waiting in the wings".

The latest fighting comes amid continuing disruption in the Strait of Hormuz, a key global shipping route. The US military said on Sunday that it had struck rocket launchers on Larak Island in the strait. Iran subsequently fired missiles at US sites in Jordan, which were intercepted, while the United Arab Emirates said it had stopped an Iranian drone over its waters.

The strait has remained at the centre of the conflict since the US and Israel attacked Iran on February 28. Iran established a chokehold over the waterway, through which about one-fifth of the world's traded oil passed in peacetime, reducing shipping traffic to a trickle. The disruption has pushed up energy and other commodity prices and added pressure to the global economy. **CONTINUED ON P4**

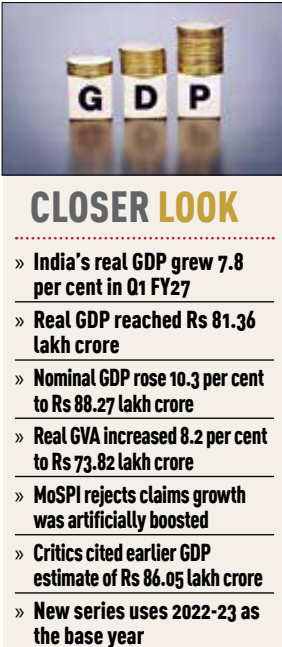
Centre rejects 2.6% GDP claim, defends 7.8% growth in 1st quarter

Releases FAQs explaining new GDP series and revised methodology

VINAY KUMAR
New Delhi, September 2

The Centre on Wednesday released a detailed set of frequently asked questions (FAQs) to address concerns over India's 7.8 per cent real GDP growth in the April-June quarter, explaining the methodology behind the new GDP series, revisions to earlier estimates, the negative manufacturing deflator and differences between GDP, consumer and wholesale inflation. The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) also rejected claims that the latest growth rate was made to look stronger by lowering last year's GDP estimate, saying the criticism compared figures from two different GDP series.

The FAQs came after Congress leaders questioned the credibility of the latest growth numbers and former finance secretary Subhash Chandra Garg argued that current-price growth would have been about 2.6 per cent if the previous year's GDP esti-



mate had not been revised.

Statistics Secretary Saurabh Garg said the comparison was an "apples and oranges" exercise because the Rs 86.05 lakh crore figure cited by critics belonged to the old 2011-12 base-year series. That series was replaced in February 2026 when the government introduced a new GDP series with 2022-23 as

the base year.

Under the new series, Q1 FY2025-26 current-price GDP was initially estimated at Rs 80.32 lakh crore. It was subsequently revised to Rs 80.44 lakh crore and then to Rs 80 lakh crore after additional data, including updated Index of Industrial Production (IIP) and Producer Price Index (PPI) series, were incorporated. MoSPI said the changes were part of the normal revision process involving a new base year, improved data sources, revised methodologies and additional indicators.

The ministry said growth comparisons should use estimates from the same series and constant prices, which remove the effect of price changes. It rejected the allegation that the earlier GDP figure had been reduced to mechanically raise the latest growth rate.

Data released on August 31 showed real GDP at Rs 81.36 lakh crore in Q1 FY2026-27, compared with Rs 75.46 lakh crore a year earlier, resulting in growth of 7.8 per cent. **CONTINUED ON P4**

Briefs

Five dead in bus-truck collision in MP

REWA (MP): Five people were killed and 30 injured after a bus collided with a truck on National Highway 39 in Madhya Pradesh's Rewa district on Wednesday, police said. The accident occurred around 4.30 pm near Badwar, under Gudh police station, about 30 km from the district headquarters.

ASP Bhavana Maravi said the collision overturned the truck and sent the bus into a water-filled drain. "Five people died in the accident, while 30 others were injured," she said. All the injured were taken to Sanjay Gandhi Hospital in Rewa, where they are being treated. **CONTINUED ON P4**

SC questions Govt over IPS deputation

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Wednesday questioned the Centre over IPS officers' deputation to CAPFs, asking if forces lacked competent leaders. Justice Ujjal Bhuyan cited officers serving 25-30 years in CRPF, ITBP and BSF without leadership roles. The remarks came as 34 CAPF officers challenge the 2026 Act, alleging violations of Articles 14, 16 and 21 and separation of powers. Parliament passed the law on April 2, after the 2025 verdict ordered deputation posts to be progressively reduced. **SEE P4**

Ram Temple Trust appoints Ex-Air Marshal Mishra as first CEO

BP SINGH
Ayodhya, September 2

The Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust on Wednesday appointed retired Air Marshal Jeetendra Mishra as the first chief executive officer of the Ram temple, as it reorganised its administration to manage the expanding operations of the religious complex in Ayodhya. Former treasurer Swami Govind Dev Giri was made general secretary, while Delhi-based Mahesh Bhagchandka was appointed treasurer.

The decisions were taken unanimously at a trust meeting held at Maniram Das Chhawani in Ayodhya, chaired by trust president Mahant Nritya Gopal Das. The meeting



was conducted in two sessions, with Uttar Pradesh Principal Secretary (Home) Sanjay Prasad attending the first session online and Ram Temple Construction Committee chairman Nripendra Misra joining the second session at 3 pm.

Mishra was chosen from three shortlisted candidates after a selection process that began with 5,585 applications. The other two candidates were retired Major General Sanjay **CONTINUED ON P4**

Nepal wants India, China, US to pay for flood damages as toll crosses 1,200

MPPOST BUREAU
Kathmandu, September 2

Nepal has sought urgent international financial support for the destruction caused by last week's deadly floods, arguing that countries responsible for a large share of global greenhouse gas emissions should help vulnerable nations meet the cost of climate-related disasters. The appeal came as Nepal's death toll from the floods rose to 1,204 on Wednesday, with 4,216 people still missing and large parts of its infrastructure damaged.

Foreign Minister Shisir Khanal said Nepal had formally approached the UN-backed Fund for Responding to Loss and Damage for assistance with relief, resettlement and reconstruction. He said the



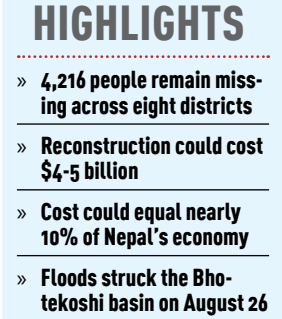
Family members perform rituals during symbolic funerals of their loved ones, who are flood victims still reported missing, in accordance with Nepali Hindu rites, at Pashupatinath temple in Kathmandu

country was moving away from treating such disasters solely as humanitarian emergencies requiring aid.

"We are shifting our diplomatic framework from aid to justice and compensation,"

Khanal told Kantipur TV. He added, "This is not a matter of charity; it is a matter of legal and moral liability."

Khanal named China, the United States and India as the world's three larg-



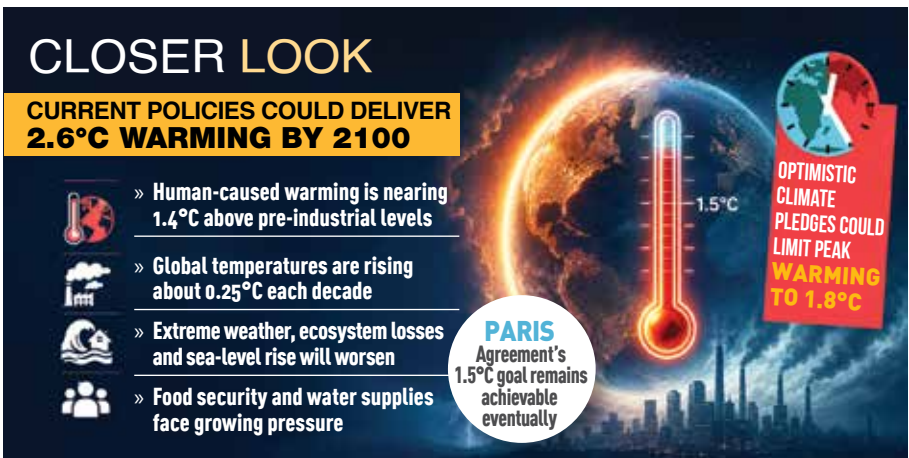
est current greenhouse gas emitters in absolute terms and said they had a responsibility towards countries such as Nepal that have contributed comparatively little to global emissions. The European Commission's EDGAR estimates for 2024 list the three countries as the largest emitters, although per-capita emissions differ sharply. **CONTINUED ON P4**

URGES RAPID ACTION TO BRING TEMPERATURES BACK DOWN

World set to breach 1.5°C climate limit by the end of decade: UN

MPPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 2

The world is likely to cross the 1.5°C global warming threshold by the end of this decade, according to a new United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) report, marking a major setback to the temperature goal agreed under the 2015 Paris Agreement. The report, however, says the threshold should not be treated as a point of no return and calls for countries to limit how far temperatures rise beyond 1.5°C, shorten the period of excess warming and eventually bring global temperatures back below the level. Without stron-



ger action, current policies could result in warming of about 2.6°C above pre-industrial levels by 2100.

UNEP's report, Limiting Overshoot, says human-

caused warming is already approaching 1.4°C above pre-industrial levels, with global temperatures rising at roughly 0.25°C per decade. If that trend con-

tinues, the 1.5°C mark could be reached around the end of the 2020s.

The Paris Agreement calls on countries to keep long-term **CONTINUED ON P4**

SC questions BCI chief's 5-year tenure, limits him to 'pro tem' role

Puts policy decisions under AG, SG watch, orders fresh election process

MPPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 2

The Supreme Court on Wednesday said Bar Council of India (BCI) chairman Manan Kumar Mishra can continue only as a "pro tem" office-bearer until a freshly constituted BCI elects its office-bearers, while directing the Attorney General for India and Solicitor General be actively associated with all policy decisions of the apex lawyers' body during the interim period. The court also set a time-bound process for reconstituting state bar councils and

electing their representatives to the BCI, effectively rejecting any assumption that the present leadership could continue until 2030.

A bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana said its concern was the institutional functioning and integrity of the BCI, not allegations against any individuals. It said routine functioning could continue under the existing arrangement, but policy decisions would require the participation of the two senior law officers, who are permanent ex officio members of the BCI. **CONTINUED ON P4**

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, September 2

India has mobilised a record \$127.23 billion through foreign-currency deposits from non-resident Indians under a special Reserve Bank of India (RBI) programme aimed at strengthening foreign-exchange liquidity amid global financial uncertainty. The strong response led the central bank to close the facility a month ahead of schedule.

FCNR(B) deposits brought in \$127.226 billion as of August 31, according to provisional RBI data released on Wednesday. Including overseas foreign-currency borrowings (OFCB) and external commercial borrowings (ECB), total funds raised under the measures stood at \$136.377 billion.

The RBI had opened the FCNR(B) window on June 8 and planned to keep it available until September 30. It closed the facility on August 31 after saying its objective had been achieved earlier than expected.

FCNR(B) deposits allow NRIs to keep fixed-term savings with Indian banks in foreign currencies, with both principal and interest repaid in the same currency. This protects depositors from direct rupee exchange-rate risk while giving Indian banks access to foreign-currency funds. The RBI measures included absorbing banks' hedging costs for mobilising these deposits and allowing banks to lend against the funds. OFCBs contributed another \$5.26 billion, while ECBs accounted for \$3.891 billion.

Private lender ICICI Bank said separately that it had mobilised \$17.88 billion in gross FCNR(B) deposits by August 31. **CONTINUED ON P4**

60-YEAR-OLD INVESTOR FOUND DEAD

Rohini robbery-murder: Niece, gym trainer, student in cop net

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

New Delhi, September 2

A 60-year-old stock market investor was found dead in northwest Delhi's Rohini, with police apprehending his 23-year-old niece and two associates in connection with the robbery-cum-murder, an officer said.

Rakesh Khanna was found unconscious at his house in Sector 3, Rohini, on Tuesday evening, with the house ransacked. A PCR call was received at 8.14 pm reporting a house theft and an unconscious person. Khanna was taken to Jaipur Golden Hospital, where doctors declared him brought dead. Prima facie, there were no visible injuries on his body.

During the investigation, police learnt that the accused knew Khanna had recently sold property worth Rs 75 lakh. Simran Taneja, his niece and a private primary school teacher from Burari, allegedly hatched the conspiracy with her friend Himanshu, a gym owner, to rob cash and valuables, Deputy Commissioner of Police (Rohini) Shashank Jaiswal said.

The accused conducted a recce of the house on Sunday, August 30, and had also attempted the crime earlier but failed. They returned on Tuesday to execute the plan.

Taneja facilitated entry.



ENTRY FACILITATED

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- » During the investigation, police learnt that the accused knew Khanna had recently sold property worth Rs 75 lakh
- » The accused conducted a recce of the house on Sunday, August 30, and had also attempted the crime earlier but failed. They returned on Tuesday to execute the plan
- » Taneja facilitated entry. She allegedly took Khanna's wife and her own mother to a fair in Paschim Vihar, leaving her uncle alone. She later reached the house in an autorickshaw and asked Khanna to open the door, police official said

She allegedly took Khanna's wife and her own mother to a fair in Paschim Vihar, leaving her uncle alone. She later reached the house in an autorickshaw and asked Khanna to open the door. Three

persons then entered while another associate kept watch outside. The accused wore helmets, caps and masks to conceal identities.

After entering, they allegedly overpowered

Khanna and pressed his mouth to prevent him from raising an alarm. He fell unconscious during the assault and subsequently died.

Around Rs 72,400 in cash and two gold rings reported stolen were recovered. Preliminary investigation led police to Taneja, who emerged as the alleged main conspirator.

Two alleged associates, Chirag (22), a Burari resident who works as a gym trainer at The Beast Gym in Baba Colony, and Paras (19), a Class XII student, were also apprehended. Paras was earlier booked in a criminal case at Mukherjee Nagar police station. Himanshu, also from Burari, is absconding and efforts are underway to arrest him. A case under Sections 103(1) (punishment for murder), 309(4) (robbery) and 3(5) (common intention) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita has been registered at South Rohini police station.

FSL and Crime Team personnel examined the crime scene. Further investigation is underway to establish the precise role of each accused, complete recovery of stolen property, ascertain the circumstances and cause of Khanna's death, and apprehend Himanshu.

12-yr-old gets 9 stitches after fan falls at SW Delhi school

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 2

A 12-year-old girl sustained a head injury and received nine stitches after a ceiling fan fell on her at a government school in southwest Delhi on Wednesday, officials said. Another Class 8 student was also injured in the incident at Sarvodaya Kanya Vidyalaya in Sagarpur, they said.

The incident occurred while the class was in progress and both students were taken to a nearby hospital for treatment, an official said.

The Deputy Director of Education, Southwest district, has constituted a fact-finding committee to inquire into the incident and submit its report within three working days.

The school principal had retired about a month ago and the matter was taken up with the district education department, the official said.

Delhi AAP chief Saurabh Bharadwaj took a swipe at Education Minister Ashish Sood over the incident. "Education Minister Ashish Sood, whenever you have time from celebrating your birthday, take time to meet the girl who sustained injury," Bharadwaj said in a post on X.

He said the girl suffered nine stitches after a fan fell on her at the school.

There was no immediate response from the school or the minister.

EAST DELHI'S SANJAY LAKE

Evening outing ends in tragedy as three drown

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 2

What began as a light-hearted evening outing with friends ended in tragedy as three youths drowned in east Delhi's Sanjay Lake after they allegedly entered the water to take a dip, police said on Wednesday.

The incident took place around 7 pm Tuesday under Pandav Nagar police station limits when Ashish Nautiyal (21), Sahil (22) and Saurabh (21) had gone to Sanjay Lake together.

According to preliminary information, Ashish waded into deeper water and began to drown. When his friends saw him go underwater, they jumped into the lake in an attempt to save him. However, neither of them made it out.

Police and rescue personnel reached the spot after receiving information about the incident. Follow-

'DDA SAID APPROPRIATE SAFETY MEASURES WERE IN PLACE AT SITE, INCLUDING WARNING SIGNS...'

ing a search operation, the bodies of all three youths were recovered from the lake. The bodies have been sent for post-mortem and further investigation into the circumstances leading to the drowning is underway, police said.

The incident has left three families grappling with loss. Ashish's father stated that his son had gone to Sanjay Lake with his friends where he drowned. "We do not know exactly what happened. But my child is lost." The family received a call regarding the incident, and has been inconsolable since. On the other hand, Delhi Development

Authority (DDA), which is responsible for maintenance of the lake, rejected allegations that the water body has deepened due to illegal sand mining carried out by the civic agency.

"With reference to the unfortunate drowning incident, it is clarified that the claims attributing the deepening of the water body and alleged illegal sand mining to the Delhi Development Authority are factually incorrect and misleading," the DDA said.

The agency said it had neither undertaken nor authorised any sand mining at the site and termed the allegation that the water body had deepened as a result of such mining activities as "completely unfounded".

The DDA said appropriate safety measures were in place at the site, including warning signs and a toe wall constructed around the water body.

Briefs

Gzb: Traffic constable found dead

GHAZIABAD: A 35-year-old traffic constable, Yogesh Sharma, was found dead in a decomposed condition at his rented accommodation in Masuri's Aakash Nagar on Wednesday. Sharma, posted with Ghaziabad traffic police, had returned from leave on August 30. His wife and children had left for her parental home on Raksha Bandhan, leaving him alone. Neighbours alerted police after noticing a foul smell. The body was sent for postmortem. Police are examining his phone records and contacts.

Two nabbed with six illegal pistols

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police arrested Honey Nihal, 20, and Jatinder Bhati, 19, for allegedly smuggling illegal arms interstate. Police recovered six country-made pistols, 10 live cartridges and a car. Bhati allegedly procured weapons from Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan and Madhya Pradesh through carriers for sale in Delhi-NCR. Further investigation is underway.

Ex-employee plots Rs 10L extortion

NEW DELHI: A 26-year-old former employee and his associate were arrested for allegedly attempting to extort Rs 10 lakh from a Rohini resident by threatening to kill him and his family, police said. A 15-year-old juvenile was also apprehended. Police recovered a country-made pistol, live round, motorcycle, mobile phones and stolen SIM cards. The main accused allegedly planned the extortion to repay gambling debts.

25-yr-old dies after fall, in-laws accused

DIPIKA KIROLA

Greater Noida, September 2

A 25-year-old married woman died after falling from the terrace of a house in Dwarka City Colony under Badalpur police station on Tuesday, with her family alleging that she was pushed to death over a dowry demand of Rs 10 lakh.

The deceased, Rachna, had married Akash, a resident of Dwarka City Colony, around a year ago, police said. Her father, Chandra Prakash, is a resident of Bulandshahr.

Rachna's family alleged that her husband and in-laws had been demanding Rs 10 lakh, reportedly to buy a car, since soon

after the marriage. They claimed she was harassed when the money was not provided.

According to the family, Rachna fell from the terrace on Tuesday morning. She was taken for medical treatment but died before treatment could be provided.

The family approached police, alleging that she had been deliberately pushed. Police sent the body for postmortem.

Badalpur police station in-charge Vijay Gupta said a complaint had been received and the circumstances were being investigated. A case was later registered and police began looking for the accused.

Worker's death spurs road safety concerns

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

New Delhi, September 2

Residents of East Mehram Nagar have raised concerns over road safety after a 48-year-old domestic worker died in an alleged road accident on August 11 while returning home from work at the police colony.

Residents said the busy stretch is used daily by people living and working in the area, but existing speed breakers have failed to slow vehicles, with drivers allegedly continuing to drive at high speed.

A key concern is the absence of a traffic signal near East Gate No. 1 of Mehram Nagar. Residents said a traffic-control measure is needed to help

'PROBLEM WORSENS IN THE EVENING AMID ALLEGED TRAFFIC POLICE ABSENCE'

pedestrians, particularly children and elderly people, cross safely. Children from Mehram Nagar and the Delhi Police Colony regularly cross the road to reach the nearby Government Sarvodaya Co-Ed School.

Residents also said the situation worsens in the evening, when traffic police personnel are allegedly not present. A divider cut is closed with barricades after 6-7 pm, forcing residents to take a longer route.

DDA kicks off MPD consultations

SHIVANGI SHUKLA

New Delhi, September 2

The Delhi Development Authority (DDA) on Tuesday began its stakeholder consultation exercise for participatory implementation of the Master Plan for Delhi 2047 (MPD 2047), with the first meeting attended by three Members of Parliament and 33 Members of the Delhi Legislative Assembly.

Held on September 1 on the directions of Lieutenant Governor Sardar Taranjit Singh Sandhu, it was attended by MPs Ramvir Singh Bidhuri, Manoj Tiwari and Praveen Khandelwal, along with 33 Delhi MLAs. DDA Vice Chairman N Saravana Kumar briefed the elected representatives on provisions of MPD 2047, including Transit Oriented



Development (TOD), High Density Corridors (HDC), Land Pooling, LDA and unauthorised colonies.

The public representatives welcomed the notification of MPD 2047 and sought 15 days to submit their observations in writing. The consultation marks the beginning of a stakeholder exercise, with around 20 meetings planned over the next three months. These will involve government agencies and service providers, industry bodies, architects and planners, resident and

group housing representatives, farmers and landowners, market and trade associations, conservation bodies, transport agencies, and education and healthcare representatives.

Thematic discussions will cover land pooling, group housing redevelopment, low-density areas, the Yamuna and blue-green zones, heritage conservation, mixed-use and commercial areas, in-situ slum redevelopment, decongestion, and the development of education and medical hubs.

Drug supplier 'with ULFA(I) links' held

New Delhi, September 2

The Delhi Police, in coordination with Assam Police, apprehended 27-year-old Apurba Thakur from Narela for allegedly supplying psychotropic tablets to an interstate narcotics network with suspected links to the banned ULFA(I), an official said on Wednesday. Thakur was wanted in an Assam case registered under the NDPS Act and UAPA. The case began on July 17 after Assam Police recovered 46.11 grams of heroin from a car in Charaideo district and arrested Manuj Gogoi.

Investigation allegedly led to Bhaskar Gogoi, whose phone revealed VoIP communications with Debasish Dahutia

THAKUR WAS A DELHI-BASED SOURCE SUPPLYING PSYCHOTROPIC TABLETS

and suspected ULFA(I) cadre Mridupawan Dahutia. Police said digital evidence indicated that Thakur was a Delhi-based source supplying psychotropic tablets to the Assam network.

An invoice and 2025 communications with Dahutia were allegedly found on Thakur's phone. A transaction involving lakhs with Bobby Gogoi is under scrutiny. Assam Police secured four-day transit remand. Investigators probe possible narco-terrorism financing. **MPUST**

47.5 lakh names off roll: Now, spotlight on poll machinery

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, September 2

Nearly one in every three electors in Delhi has not made it to the draft electoral roll prepared after the Special Intensive Revision (SIR), putting the spotlight on the election machinery's ability to handle what could become a substantial volume of claims and objections before the final roll is published.

Delhi had around 1.45 crore electors when the SIR exercise began. After the house-to-house enumer-

ation, the draft roll published on August 31 contains around 97.5 lakh names, leaving 47.5 lakh electors outside the draft, nearly 33 per cent of the earlier electorate.

The Election Commission has categorised the missing entries under reasons including absent, permanently shifted, deceased, duplicate and other cases. The largest group comprises around 43.3 lakh electors marked absent or shifted, while around 2.8 lakh were reported deceased and 1.4 lakh identified as duplicate

or multiple entries.

However, not appearing in the draft roll does not by itself mean that an elector has permanently lost the right to vote. Eligible voters can seek inclusion during the claims and objections period.

The scale of the exercise raises a key logistical question of how much workload could the election machinery face if a significant share of those missing from the draft approaches the authorities?

Even if just 10 per cent of the 47.5 lakh electors seek



inclusion, the system would have to process about 4.8

lakh claims, averaging nearly 16,000 a day over

the 30-day claims period. If the response reaches 25 per cent, the figure would rise to about 11.9 lakh claims, or nearly 40,000 a day. At a 50 per cent response, the potential volume would be around 23.8 lakh claims.

The workload is also unlikely to be evenly distributed across Delhi's 70 Assembly constituencies. Several constituencies have more than 40 per cent of their existing electors outside the draft roll. Tughlakabad has the highest proportion at about 48 per cent, followed by

Okhla at around 45 per cent, indicating that some areas could face a substantially heavier claims burden than others.

The first indications of the response are already emerging. By September 2, around 2.18 lakh Form 6 applications had been received cumulatively, including 3,605 on September 1, according to the Delhi CEO's bulletin. Form 6 is used by eligible voters seeking inclusion in the electoral roll.

The claims and objections window will remain

open until September 30, while the process of issuing notices, conducting hearings and disposing of claims is scheduled to continue until October 29. The final electoral roll is due to be published on November 4.

The Election Commission has maintained that the exercise is intended to ensure that no eligible citizen is left out while preventing ineligible names from entering the electoral roll.

The coming weeks will therefore test the administrative capacity of Delhi's election machinery.

MOVE AIMS TO SIMPLIFY APPROVALS, REGISTRATIONS, CLEARANCES... Fewer hurdles, easier business in Delhi

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 2

The Delhi Cabinet has approved the 'Ease of Doing Business' Bill, 2025, seeking fundamental changes in the existing processes for approvals, registrations, licences and clearances required by businesses and individuals.

The Bill, prepared as part of the second phase of the Government of India initiative to reduce regulatory and compliance burdens, was passed at the Delhi Cabinet meeting chaired by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday, a statement from the Chief Minister's Office said.

The legislation will now be sent to the Ministry of Home Affairs for its approval.

The burden of duplicate registrations on businesses would also be reduced by



EASE OF BUSINESS

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fire-related approvals, and water, sewer and electricity connections.

Citizens and businesses will no longer need to visit different government offices and submit separate applications. The Delhi State Industrial and Infrastructure Development Corporation (DSIIDC) will be the single nodal agency for all business approvals provided through this single-window system, it said.

For several activities included in Schedule-3 of the Bill, approvals, permissions, licences or no-objection certificates will be granted as soon as the applications are submitted.

Self-declaration will be accepted for specified low-risk categories and cases falling within the prescribed limits. This will provide relief from lengthy approval processes for low-risk activities.

For activities not covered under Schedule-3, approvals, permissions, licences and no-objection certificates will be provided within the timelines prescribed under the Right to Timely and Easy Delivery of Services to Citizens Act, 2026.

The Bill also proposes a provision for deemed approval upon expiry of the prescribed time limit. This means that if the competent authority does not make a decision within the stipulated period, the approval will be deemed granted in accordance with the provisions of the Bill.

A negative-list based system would be adopted to provide greater freedom to conduct business. Under this system, an enterprise will be able to carry out any activity at any location, provided the activity is not included in the negative

list specified in Schedule-2 of the Bill.

The chief minister said the Delhi government is working to create a system in which business owners and entrepreneurs do not have to visit multiple government offices, submit the same information repeatedly, or wait long periods for necessary approvals.

The proposed law also provides for an inspection system based on trust. No routine inspection will be carried out for three years after an enterprise is registered. However, an inspection may be conducted if a serious complaint is received, the CMO said.

These measures are expected to significantly reduce the time, cost and uncertainty involved in doing business in Delhi and help attract new investment and create employment on a larger scale, Gupta said.

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 2

The Delhi government has begun a fresh round of preparations ahead of the winter pollution season, combining a push for cleaner commercial vehicles with district-level hotspot mapping, tighter dust checks and continuous monitoring of industrial emissions.

As part of the Centre's Rs 9,585-crore Parivartan scheme, nearly 78,000 BS-III and BS-IV heavy vehicles registered in Delhi have been identified for a possible shift to BS-VI-compliant vehicles. Officials said the transition is voluntary at present and efforts are focused on persuading vehicle owners to make the switch.

"Teams are engaging directly with major truck operators and transporters. We are also covering petrol stations, parking locations and industrial areas, where many of these vehicles are regularly deployed," a senior government official said.

The official said the administration was seeking to build awareness rather than impose an immediate mandate. "The owners of nearly 78,000 BS-III and BS-IV heavy vehicles have been identified. For now, participation is voluntary, and our priority is to explain the benefits and encourage owners to move to cleaner vehicles," the official said.

Under the scheme, buyers of eligible new BS-VI diesel or CNG vehicles and electric vehicles can avail themselves of several incentives. These include exemption from motor vehicle tax and registration charges, five per cent

interest subvention on loans and discounts of up to eight per cent from participating manufacturers. Owners of eligible BS-VI diesel and CNG vehicles can receive fuel vouchers worth Rs 1,200 to Rs 4,800 per month for five years, depending on the vehicle category. Electric commercial vehicles are eligible for one-time incentives of Rs 64,000 to Rs 2.56 lakh.

District administrations have also been tasked with preparing area-specific pollution plans. Teams headed by deputy commissioners and district magistrates will identify traffic and pollution hotspots and recommend local engineering interventions.

"Each district will assess its own problem areas, particularly locations facing recurring traffic congestion and pollution. The reports will help us determine what local interventions are required, and the districts have been asked to submit their recommendations by the end of September," the official said.

The government has meanwhile expanded construction and demolition waste collection infrastructure, increasing the number of designated sites from 106 to 125.

Its AI-enabled anti-pollution portal, launched in July, has also intensified dust surveillance, with cameras detecting around 2,000 locations where prescribed measures were not being followed.

On the industrial front, air-quality control equipment has been made mandatory for 80 categories of industries, while more than 90 units have been brought under compulsory Online Emission Monitoring System requirements.

Briefs

NDMC's waste push goes local

NEW DELHI: The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) has stepped up its citizen outreach on waste management, organising a Jan Bhagidari campaign across residential colonies to encourage source segregation and responsible disposal of waste. The campaign, held on its second day at D1-D2 Officers' Flats in Satya Marg, Officers' Flats on Shah Jahan Road and Blocks 1-8 of the Central Government Employees' Flats on BKS Marg, focused on segregation of wet and dry waste, particularly plastic. Residents were encouraged to bring segregated plastic and wet waste, which was exchanged for organic compost prepared from wet and horticulture waste. They also participated in a Waste Segregation Pledge.

Suvidha Camp set for Sept 5

NEW DELHI: The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) will organise its monthly Suvidha Camp on September 5 at the NDCC Convention Centre, Jai Singh Road, from 10.30 a.m. to 12.30 p.m. The camp will provide residents a single-window platform to raise civic grievances and seek assistance on electricity connections, property tax, birth and death certificates, sanitation, waste management, waterlogging, road maintenance and pension-related matters.

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, September 2

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Wednesday heard grievances of citizens from across the city at a public hearing at the Chief Minister's Janseva Sadan and directed officials to ensure prompt and time-bound resolution of their complaints.

"The government's doors must always remain open to the people. This is our working culture," Gupta said, stressing that citizens should be able to approach the government directly, have their concerns heard sensitively and should not be forced to make unnecessary rounds of government offices.

The grievances raised



during the hearing included issues related to education, pending award money, waterlogging, sewerage, electrical safety, sanitation, illegal construction and unauthorised connections. Gupta directed the concerned officials to

investigate the complaints and take necessary action according to the seriousness of each case.

She also instructed officials to prioritise complaints that had remained pending for a long time. Some citizens said they

had approached departments earlier but their issues remained unresolved despite considerable delays. "The purpose of a public hearing is not merely to listen to citizens' complaints, but to take them through to a resolution,"

the Chief Minister said.

Gupta particularly stressed sensitive and prompt action in matters concerning the safety and education of students.

The hearing also saw women expressing enthusiasm over the Delhi Lakshmi Yojana, under which the first instalment of Rs 2,500 was released to eligible women from September 1. Women who met the Chief Minister thanked her and described the scheme as an important step towards their economic empowerment. Some citizens also presented Gupta with Laddu Gopal idols they had prepared themselves and extended Janmashtami greetings to the Chief Minister.

GST dept team seizes 4.20L sticks of imported cigarettes

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 2

The Delhi government's GST department has seized 4.20 lakh sticks of imported cigarettes worth around Rs 65 lakh, according to an official statement issued Wednesday. In keeping with CM's commitment to zero tolerance towards corruption and tax evasion, the Goods and Services Tax (GST) department has initiated major action against tax evasion and the illegal trade in tobacco products, the statement said.

During a routine inspection, an anti-evasion branch team of the GST department seized a vehicle carrying around 4.20 lakh sticks of imported 'Esse Light' super-slim, premium filter cigarettes -- estimated to be worth around Rs 65 lakh. The action was taken under the provisions of the GST Act, 2017, it said.

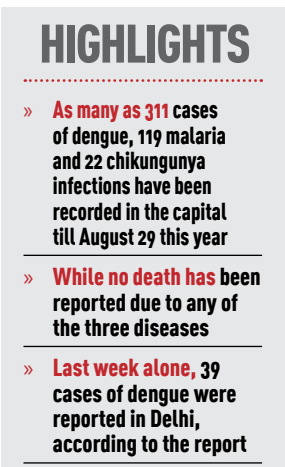
SHARP RISE IN VECTOR-BORNE DISEASES City sees highest number of dengue cases in August

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 2

Delhi recorded its highest monthly tally of dengue cases this year in August, with 90 infections reported during the month, while the number of malaria and chikungunya cases also rose, according to the latest Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) report.

As many as 311 cases of dengue, 119 malaria and 22 chikungunya infections have been recorded in the capital till August 29 this year, while no death has been reported due to any of the three diseases. Last week alone, 39 cases of dengue were reported in Delhi, according to the report.

August accounted for 90 of the 311 dengue cases, more than double the 40 cases recorded in July. It was also the highest monthly dengue tally recorded so far



HIGHLIGHTS

» As many as 311 cases of dengue, 119 malaria and 22 chikungunya infections have been recorded in the capital till August 29 this year

» While no death has been reported due to any of the three diseases

» Last week alone, 39 cases of dengue were reported in Delhi, according to the report

this year. April logged the second highest number of cases this year, with 52 infections reported. Malaria cases also rose sharply in August, with 53 cases reported during the month, compared to 17 in July. Chikungunya cases remained lower but also saw a rise, with eight cases reported in August,

taking the year's tally to 22 so far. Three chikungunya cases were reported in July.

The West zone recorded the highest number of dengue cases among the MCD's 12 zones, with 47 cases, followed by Shahdara North with 32, and Central with 39. For malaria, South Delhi had the highest tally at 22, followed by West with 22, and Central with 16. However, recent figures from the Delhi government paint a very different picture.

Delhi Health Minister Pankaj Singh told reporters last week that 2,200 cases of dengue had been detected till August 25. There is no explanation for the inconsistency in figures by the government and the MCD. As part of mosquito-control measures, till August 29, MCD teams have made more than 2.56 crore house visits to check for mosquito breeding.

Delhi PWD starts beautification and road works ahead of BRICS

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 2

The Public Works Department (PWD) has started beautification and road improvement works in areas around Bharat Mandapam, the airport, Rajghat and other key locations ahead of the BRICS summit here, officials said on Wednesday.

The Delhi government has directed the Public Works Department and other civic agencies to make necessary arrangements for the international event, they said.

"During the summit, various heads of state and foreign delegates are expected to visit Delhi. Work has already started, and officials have been directed to prune trees, clean roads and ensure there is no waterlogging," an official said.



Rain cools Delhi's heat

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 2

Rain swept several parts of Delhi on Wednesday, bringing down temperatures and providing relief from the humid weather, with more likely through the night.

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) has issued a 'yellow' alert for Delhi, forecasting light to moderate rainfall and spells of moderate to heavy rain during the evening and night.

The Palam weather station recorded 3.1 mm of rainfall between 8.30 am and 5.30 pm, Ayaznagar 3.9 mm and Lodhi Road 0.8 mm.

Safdarjung, the capital's primary weather station, and the Ridge did not record any rainfall during this period.

Safdarjung recorded a maximum temperature of 31.3 degrees Celsius -- 3.2 notches below normal.

Palam recorded a maximum temperature of 30 degrees Celsius, 4.8 notches below normal, and Lodhi Road recorded 31.2 degrees Celsius, 1.8 notches below normal.

The Ridge recorded the highest maximum temperature at 32.8 degrees Celsius, 1.6 notches below normal, while Ayaznagar recorded 29.4 degrees Celsius, 5.5 notches below normal.

‘DO YOU THINK THAT THERE ARE NO COMPETENT OFFICERS IN THE CAPFS TO HOLD LEADERSHIP POSITIONS’

SC questions Centre over deputation of IPS officers in leadership roles in CAPF

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 2

The Supreme Court on Wednesday questioned the Centre over its alleged inability to resolve the tussle between IPS and in-house officers of paramilitary forces over deputation and seniority in service.

Earlier, the top court had issued a notice to the Centre on a plea by the officers of paramilitary forces challenging the constitutional validity of the Central Armed Police Forces (General Administration) Act, 2026, on the ground that it “violates the doctrine of separation of powers”. On Wednesday, a bench of Justices Ujjal

CLOSER LOOK

» ‘There are officers who served for 25-30 years in CRPF, ITBP and BSF, and yet they have not been given leadership positions’

» The law officer defended the government’s move and said the decision regarding the CAPF was not a ‘this versus that issue’ but a policy decision

Bhuyan and A S Chandurkar, while questioning the Centre over the deputation of IPS officers in the CAPF, asked Additional Solicitor General Aishwarya Bhati whether there were no competent officers for holding leadership positions in paramili-

tary forces. “Do you think that there are no competent officers in the Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs) to hold leadership positions,” Justice Bhuyan asked. Pointing out that it was a wrong step, Justice Bhuyan said, “There are officers who served for

25-30 years in CRPF, ITBP and BSF, and yet they have not been given leadership positions.”

“Why are you treating them like this,” he went on, adding, “They are also defending our borders. They are also fighting for us and making supreme sacrifices...”

The law officer defended the government’s move and said the decision regarding the CAPF was not a “this versus that issue” but a policy decision. On August 4, the bench had tagged the plea of 34 CAPF officers with pending matters. The plea filed by the officers sought a declaration that the law is unconstitutional on the ground that it vio-

lates Articles 14, 16 and 21 of the Constitution.

Parliament passed the CAPF (General Administration) Bill on April 2 after the top court dismissed the Centre’s plea in October 2025 for a review of its verdict delivered in May that year directing that IPS officers’ deputation in the CAPFs, up to the level of senior administrative grade (SAG), should be “progressively reduced” and asked for a cadre review to be carried out within six months.

The 34 officers argued in their plea that the new CAPF Act negated the judgements of last year, without removing the legal basis of those decisions.

The plea contended

that while the legislature is competent to amend the law retrospectively, it cannot simply nullify judicial pronouncements without curing the defects or altering the underlying legal basis on which the judgement was rendered.

In its order dated May 23, 2025, the top court had directed the Centre to conduct a cadre review, which was due in 2021, in all CAPFs, including the ITBP, BSF, CRPF, CISF and SSB, within six months.

It directed the Department of Personnel and Training to take an appropriate decision within three months of receiving the action taken report from the Ministry of Home Affairs regarding

cadre review and review of the existing service and recruitment rules.

The court’s directions came on a batch of pleas seeking non-functional financial upgrade, cadre review and restructuring and amendment of recruitment rules to eliminate Indian Police Service (IPS) officers’ deputation.

“Keeping in mind the twin objectives of service mobility of the cadre officers of CAPFs, removing stagnation on the one hand and the operational/functional requirement of the forces on the other, we are of the view that the number of posts earmarked for deputation in the cadres of the CAPFs up to the level of

senior administrative grade should be progressively reduced over a period of time, say within an outer limit of two years,” the top court had said. It also said that this step would bring in a sense of participation of the cadre officers belonging to the CAPFs in the decision-making process within the administrative framework of the CAPFs, thereby removing the long-standing grievances of the cadre officers.

The apex court had highlighted that the Centre had taken the view that the presence of IPS officers in each of the CAPFs is vital to maintain the character of each of them as a unique central armed force.

From page 1

US and Iran

Two ships were also reported attacked in and around the strait on Monday. The British military’s United Kingdom Maritime Trade Operations Centre said a tanker was hit by three projectiles while leaving the Persian Gulf through the Strait of Hormuz east of Oman. A separate report involved a tanker and military forces off Oman’s coast, east of the strait. No group immediately claimed responsibility.

Iran has been working with Oman on a framework to manage shipping through the waterway, although it remains uncertain whether Washington would accept the arrangement. Other Gulf states have called for the strait to be reopened without conditions. Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman met Oman’s Sultan Haitham bin Tariq on Tuesday, with the Saudi Press Agency saying the talks covered “ongoing efforts to maintain regional security and stability”, without specifically referring to the strait.

The conflict has also complicated international monitoring of Iran’s nuclear programme. The International Atomic Energy Agency said in a confidential report circulated to member states that it had been unable to inspect Iranian nuclear facilities affected by the 12-day war in June 2025. As a result, the watchdog said it “cannot provide any information on the current size, composition or whereabouts” of Iran’s enriched uranium stockpile.

Iran’s political leadership remains divided over the path forward. President Masoud Pezeshkian has supported a negotiated settlement, while the powerful Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps is seeking greater concessions from Washington, including Iranian control of the Strait of Hormuz and financial compensation for war-related losses. Such demands are likely to pose difficulties for negotiations with the US.

The renewed fighting has also prompted Washington to issue a fresh region-wide travel alert. The State Department said the security situation across the Middle East remained complex and warned of possible unforeseen escalation and travel disruptions, urging Americans in the region to exercise heightened vigilance.

Economic pressure is meanwhile mounting inside Iran. US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent called on countries and businesses to stop trading with Iran, saying sanctions would “asphyxiate the regime”. Iranian economists have warned that the worsening conflict could contribute to hyperinflation in coming months. Central Bank governor Abdolnaser Hemmati has played down the likelihood of such an outcome while acknowledging that economic hardship is increasing.

Elsewhere in the region, Israel said its forces detained a senior Hamas security official during a special forces raid in Gaza City on Tuesday. Hospital officials said at least four people, including two children, were killed. Israeli authorities identified the target as the head of Hamas’ internal security, while Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu described the detainee, whose name was not released, as “one of the most senior Hamas leaders” and said he had recently been involved in efforts to restore Hamas governance in Gaza.

In Yemen, Saudi-backed Yemeni government forces and counterterrorism units killed Islamic State spokesperson Abu Huzayfah al-Ansari during a dawn operation in Seiyun city in Hadramout province. Yemen’s state security said he was hiding in a house when the operation took place. A US official said American forces were not involved.

GDP claim

Nominal GDP rose 10.3 per cent to Rs 88.27 lakh crore from Rs 80 lakh crore, while real GVA increased 8.2 per cent to Rs 73.82 lakh crore.

A major section of the FAQs dealt with the manufacturing sector’s negative 1.5 per cent implicit GVA deflator. MoSPI said the figure does not mean manufacturing prices declined.

The new GDP methodology uses double deflation for manufacturing, under which output and intermediate consumption are separately adjusted for price changes before real GVA is calculated. If input prices rise faster than output prices, nominal GVA can grow more slowly than real GVA. This can produce a negative implicit deflator even when both input and output prices are increasing.

Manufacturing real GVA grew 9.2 per cent in Q1 FY27, compared with nominal growth of 7.7 per cent, resulting in an implicit GVA deflator of minus 1.5 per cent. MoSPI cited textiles and cotton spinning, basic metals, and rubber and plastic products as activities where input-price growth exceeded output-price growth.

The ministry said similar negative or volatile manufacturing deflators can occur internationally when economies use double deflation during periods of sharp energy and raw-material price movements.

Agriculture is treated differently. Quarterly agricultural GVA is first estimated at constant prices using production data, with current-price estimates calculated later using the relevant producer-price index. The agriculture, forestry and fishing output PPI rose about 5 per cent during the quarter, resulting in an implied inflation rate of 3.9 per cent.

The FAQs also addressed why the implied GDP inflation rate of about 2.5 per cent differs from consumer inflation of 3.9 per cent and wholesale inflation of more than 9 per cent.

MoSPI said the GDP deflator is an economy-wide measure derived from the ratio of nominal to real GDP. It covers price movements associated with investment, government expenditure, exports and a broad range of services. By comparison, the Consumer Price Index tracks prices paid by households for a defined consumption basket, while the Wholesale Price Index focuses largely on goods and commodities and excludes services.

The ministry said more than 300 individual price deflators are used in GDP compilation. Differences in coverage, weights, price concepts and sectoral movements therefore mean the GDP deflator does not have to move in line with CPI or WPI.

MoSPI used mining to explain another apparent gap between nominal and real growth. Real mining and quarrying GVA contracted 2.4 per cent in Q1 FY27, while nominal GVA increased 22.3 per cent.

Mining IIP declined 3.8 per cent in April and 1.4 per cent in May before rising 1.6 per cent in June. At the same time, mining and quarrying PPI inflation stood at 22 per cent in April, 21.2 per cent in May and 15.5 per cent in June. Prices of crude petroleum and natural gas rose as much as 72.2 per cent in May, while metal-ore prices increased by more than 23 per cent in each of the three months.

The ministry said the sharp increase in mineral prices largely explains why nominal mining GVA rose even as real output contracted.

The FAQs also clarified that double deflation is used for production-side GVA and is not directly applied to Private Final Consumption Expenditure (PFCE).

On the statistical discrepancy between GDP calculated through production and expenditure approaches, MoSPI said it is a balancing item that can change as more complete data become available. Its size alone cannot establish that GDP has been overstated or understated. Future revisions could move the estimate in either direction, depending on changes in the underlying production and expenditure-side data.

The ministry said such discrepancies become very small or zero in final current-price estimates, citing FY2022-23 and FY2023-24 as examples.

The government’s FAQs followed criticism from Congress leaders over the 7.8 per cent growth figure. Jairam Ramesh cited former finance secretary Subhash Chandra Garg, who said, “If you had not revised last year’s GDP, the growth in current prices would have been 2.6 per cent.”

Ramesh said, “PR can polish the picture of GDP, but not the economy itself,” while Congress leader Pawan Khera questioned the revisions and sought greater clarity on the growth calculation. Union minister Kiren Rijiju rejected the criticism and attacked the Congress over its response to the growth figures.

The updated GDP series, released on August 31, incorporates the 2022-23 base year, a new Output PPI, a Banking Services Price Index and additional administrative data. The Reserve Bank of India has projected full-year FY27 GDP growth at 6.7 per cent.

The next quarterly GDP estimates, covering Q2 FY27, are scheduled to be released on November 30, 2026.

India draws

International branches and subsidiaries of the bank provided \$9 billion in loans against these deposits, while standby letters of credit linked to such loans stood at \$3.63 billion.

The latest mobilisation is much larger than the RBI’s 2013 response to the “taper tantrum”, when a special FCNR(B) swap scheme attracted about \$26 billion in nearly three months as the rupee came under heavy pressure.

The latest inflows come as India’s foreign exchange reserves reached a record \$729.328 billion in the week ended August 21, rising \$12.422 billion. Banking-system surplus liquidity also climbed to nearly Rs 5 lakh crore by the end of August, its highest level in more than four months.

India’s economy grew 7.8 per cent in April-June, above the RBI’s 7 per cent forecast, despite global geopolitical and economic uncertainty.

Nepal wants

India’s emissions are about three tonnes of CO2 equivalent per person, compared with roughly 11 tonnes in China and more than 17 tonnes in the US.

The Bhotekoshi river basin floods struck on August 26, devastating areas of Rasuwa, Nuwakot and Dhading and affecting several other districts. Homes, roads, bridges and hydropower facilities were damaged, while thousands were displaced. Nepal has described the disaster as a “Himalayan Tsunami”.

The National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority said 1,204 people had died across eight districts. Security forces recovered 348 bodies in Chitawan, 217 in Nawalparasi East, 202 in Nawalparasi West, 155 in Nuwakot, 115 in Rasuwa, 69 in Gorkha, 60 in Dhading and 38 in Tanahu. Of those missing, 583 are foreigners. About 21,314 security personnel have been deployed, rescuing 11,993 people by helicopter and land routes.

Nepal’s Finance Minister Swarnim Wagle has estimated that reconstruction could cost \$4 billion to \$5 billion, nearly 10% of the country’s economy. The government is also seeking specialist assistance, including tunnel-rescue teams, forensic experts and Bailey bridges.

India has meanwhile continued its relief effort. On Wednesday, it sent a fifth aircraft carrying an 11-member rescue team, specialised equipment and 5.5 tonnes of medicines. India has supplied 68.5 tonnes of relief materials in total, along with medical

and technical teams.

The floods damaged 35 motorable bridges, 45 suspension bridges and 40 km of black-topped roads, according to local authorities.

Nepal is also considering sending Prime Minister Balendra Shah to New York for the 81st UN General Assembly, beginning September 8, to raise the disaster and its demand for climate justice.

Ram Temple

Pratap Singh Bisht and Shruti Hardwar. Interim secretary Krishna Mohan said the selection committee had been asked to shortlist three names within a month before the trust took the final decision.

Mishra, a native of Deoria district in Uttar Pradesh, served the Indian Air Force for nearly four decades and rose to the rank of Air Marshal. He commanded the Western Air Command during Operation Sindoor and also held senior positions including deputy chief of Integrated Defence Staff. Commissioned as a fighter pilot on December 6, 1986, he trained at the National Defence Academy and Air Force Test Pilots School, flew more than 18 types of aircraft and logged over 3,000 flying hours. His military service earned him several decorations, including the Ati Vishisht Seva Medal, Vishisht Seva Medal and Yudh Seva Medal.

As CEO, Mishra will oversee the temple’s day-to-day administrative operations, including personnel, facilities, security, crowd management, darshan arrangements and coordination with government agencies. Giri said the trust could appoint a joint CEO or deputy CEO if necessary and would frame a standard operating procedure defining the CEO’s responsibilities.

Giri, who succeeds Champat Rai as general secretary, will now oversee the trust’s executive and administrative functioning. Rai and trustee Anil Mishra had resigned following allegations linked to the theft of donations at the temple. An SIT investigation followed, and eight people involved in donation counting were arrested.

The trust also inducted three new trustees: senior Ayodhya advocate Madan Mohan Pandey, who represented Ram Lalla Virajman in the title dispute; Mahesh Bhagchandka of Delhi; and Dr Nirmala Yadav of Shikohabad, a retired college principal and academician with postgraduate degrees in Hindi and Sanskrit. Giri said Krishna Mohan had helped steer the trust through “troubled times”. He added, “We have to make Ayodhya the world’s cultural capital. We will not leave any stone unturned for this.”

UN warming below 1.5°C while pursuing efforts to limit it to well below 2°C. The new report acknowledges that preventing the 1.5°C threshold from being crossed is no longer realistic, but says it remains possible to return below it later.

Under the most optimistic pathway, involving full implementation of countries’ current climate plans and additional net-zero commitments, warming would peak at about 1.8°C, with a possible range of 1.7°C to 2.2°C, before declining. The report describes this as an “overshoot, peak and decline” pathway. Under current policies, the projected 2100 warming is about 2.6°C, with a range of 1.9°C to 3.6°C. “1.5 target is still the goal. But now we need to approach it differently from above,” UNEP Executive Director Inger Andersen said.

Crossing 1.5°C would not cause an immediate global climate collapse, but the report says risks would increase with every additional fraction of a degree and every year spent at higher temperatures. Expected consequences include more severe heatwaves, floods and other extreme weather, damage to ecosystems, declining food and water security, health impacts, economic losses and rising risks for low-lying coastal areas and small island states.

The report also warns that prolonged warming increases the possibility of irreversible tipping points, including the destabilisation of the Greenland and West Antarctic ice sheets, degradation of the Amazon rainforest and disruption of the Atlantic Meridional Overturning Circulation, a system of ocean currents that helps regulate climate.

The warning comes days after a glacial collapse and flash flood in Nepal that killed 1,127 people and left thousands missing. Climate scientist Richard Betts of the University of Exeter said such events are expected to become more common as warming increases.

Reducing emissions quickly is central to limiting the peak. UNEP also points to methane and other short-lived pollutants as important targets in the near term. Every five years of delay in cutting emissions could add at least 0.1°C to peak warming, according to report co-author Joeri Rogelj of Imperial College London.

Countries will also need stronger adaptation measures because some damage cannot be avoided. The report describes this period as one of “coping and containment”, with greater risks of deaths and illness, food shortages, water stress, economic disruption and species loss.

Returning below 1.5°C would eventually require removing carbon dioxide from the atmosphere as well as cutting fossil fuel emissions. The report says planting trees alone could reduce global temperatures by no more than about 0.1°C, meaning other carbon removal methods would be needed.

UN Secretary-General António Guterres said recent heatwaves, wildfires and deadly floods offer a warning of what could lie ahead. “We must make the overshoot above 1.5 degrees as small and short as possible,” he said, calling for greater ambition in climate action.

SC questions

“We are not placing any stamp of approval upon the existing arrangement,” Justice Bagchi observed, adding that Mishra could continue only until fresh BCI elections were held under the Advocates Act, 1961.

The court was hearing petitions challenging Mishra’s prolonged tenure and notifications extending the terms of the BCI chairman and vice-chairman to five years. Senior advocate Madhavi Divan, representing petitioners, said Mishra was unanimously elected chairman on March 2, 2025, for a term from April 17, 2025, to April 16, 2030. She pointed to a January 9, 2025, resolution extending the tenure from three years to five years, despite Rule 12(2) prescribing a two-year term.

Divan also challenged reliance on the proviso to Section 4(3) of the Advocates Act, arguing that a provision intended to prevent an administrative vacuum had been used to avoid elections and retain existing office-bearers. The bench said the provision was transitional and that the issue may no longer survive after state bar council elections were completed.

The court directed newly constituted state bar councils to elect their chairpersons, vice-chairpersons, other office-bearers and BCI representatives within three weeks of notification of their composition. It also said high courts would complete the co-option process for women members as part of the reconstitution exercise. The matter will be heard next on September 23.

The bench also questioned the creation in 2020 of the Bar Council of India Trust for Promotion of Education, Legal and Professional Reforms and Improvement in Research. Senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan alleged that its deed made 11 managing trustees “original and permanent trustees”, regardless of their tenure as BCI members. The court questioned whether elected members of a statutory body could make themselves permanent trustees of assets belonging to that body.

The BCI agreed to the involvement of the Attorney General and Solicitor General in policy matters. The court clarified that their role would not extend to routine day-to-day functioning but would apply whenever decisions with significant policy implications were considered.

Five dead

Additional beds have been kept ready for more patients, SDM Anurag Tiwari said.

Police and administrative teams reached the spot after locals began rescue efforts. Operations continued to check whether anyone remained trapped inside the bus.

Chief Minister Mohan Yadav announced Rs 2 lakh for each deceased person’s family and Rs 1 lakh for each seriously injured victim. Police are investigating the cause of the crash.

AGENCIES

Briefs

EAM to visit Ukr, Poland

NEW DELHI: External Affairs minister S Jaishankar will undertake a three-day visit to Ukraine and Poland beginning Friday.

Jaishankar's trip to Ukraine assumes significance as it comes amid escalation of hostilities between Kyiv and Moscow.

"External Affairs minister S Jaishankar will undertake an official visit to Ukraine and the Republic of Poland from September 3 to 5," the MEA said.

'Why no FIR over Ajit Pawar's death'

THANE: NCP (SP) working president Supriya Sule on Wednesday said the Maharashtra govt has registered a case against MNS leader Amit Thackeray for removing the Prime Minister's photograph, but no FIR has been registered yet in connection with the death of then Deputy Chief Minister Ajit Pawar in an air crash.

She also opposed the upcoming or proposed big-ticket projects in Thane such as a Ring Metro and an Amazon Data Centre.

Jaipur school building razed

JAIPUR: A government school building in Jaipur's Sanganer block, which was declared dilapidated in September 2025, has been razed by authorities, days after the Cockroach Janata Party's (CJP) exposed that its classes were being held in a cowshed.

The old building of Government Primary School, Rampura, was bulldozed in the presence of district administration and education department officials, an officer said.

TN CM's gift to farmers, teachers

CHENNAI: Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay informed the Assembly on Wednesday that police cases pending against farmers who peacefully protested for their rights opposing Parandur airport and SIP-COT industrial park expansion projects will be withdrawn.

Similarly, cases against teachers who protested in a democratic manner for their rights and demands will be dropped, he said.

Tiger kills sanitation worker

JAIPUR: A woman sanitation worker was mauled to death by a tiger in Nahargarh Biological Park here on Wednesday, when a forest guard allegedly opened the gate of its enclosure oblivious of a group of women working inside, officials said. The forest department has suspended the guard and ordered an inquiry, while the victim's family and villagers staged a protest demanding compensation.

RIJIJU SLAMS CONG FOR QUESTIONING GDP NUMBERS

Cong: PR can polish image of GDP but not economy itself

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 2

The Congress on Wednesday cited former finance secretary Subhash Chandra Garg's reported remarks on GDP numbers to attack the Modi government, saying it must understand that "PR can polish the picture" of the GDP but not the economy itself.

Congress general secretary in-charge communications Jairam Ramesh shared a video clip of Garg in which he stated that by revising last year's GDP by as much as Rs 6 trillion, the current year's GDP in the first quarter has gone up by around 10.3 per cent.

"If you had not revised last year's GDP, the growth in current prices would have been 2.6 per cent," Garg told a news channel.

In his post in Hindi on X, Ramesh said that no matter how much the Modi government beats the drum of its fabricated GDP growth, conjured up through statistical jugglery by its team and media, its true reality will be exposed because what they are claiming is the complete opposite of ground realities.

"Former Finance Secretary Subhash Garg has now burst the bubble on this claim. His assessment is that the real GDP growth is around 2.6 per cent, not 7.8 per cent," Ramesh said. "We want the economy



Union minister Kiren Rijiju

CLOSER LOOK

- » Congress cited former finance secretary Subhash Chandra Garg's reported remarks on GDP numbers to attack the government
- » The Congress termed the latest GDP numbers released by the government as 'statistical gymnastics'

to truly be strong, but the path to a strong economy doesn't come from embellishing numbers fabricated on a foundation of lies - it comes from accepting the truth," the Congress leader said.

"The Modi government must understand: PR can polish the picture of GDP, but not the economy itself," the Congress general secretary said.

Congress' media and publicity department head Pawan Kherra also lashed out at the Modi government over Garg's remarks.

"Subhash Garg has punctured the government's tall claims of 7.8

per cent GDP growth, arguing that India's real GDP growth is closer to 2.6 per cent. His contention is even more damning: the previous year's GDP growth was revised downward, making this year's growth rate look stronger by comparison," Kherra said on X.

His assessment seems far closer to the lived reality of ordinary Indians - rising prices, falling purchasing power, shrinking disposable incomes and savings, stagnant job opportunities, and rising household debt, he said.

"These claims cannot simply be dismissed. They come from someone who

served as Finance and Economic Affairs Secretary of the Government of India under Modi between 2017 and 2019," Kherra said.

"The government now owes the country a clear explanation: Why were last year's GDP numbers revised downward? Why is it fudging numbers? What is the real GDP growth?" he said.

The Congress on Tuesday termed the latest GDP numbers released by the government as "statistical gymnastics" and said the Make in India initiative has achieved very little but the Modi government's signature "Fake in India" scheme continues unabated.

Attacking the Congress for questioning India's GDP numbers, Union minister Kiren Rijiju on Wednesday asked if the Opposition party was in a "state of deep intoxication" or had become "so swayed by their blind loathing of India's growth that they lost touch with ground reality".

Rijiju made the remarks in a post on X in reply to a post by Kerala Congress, which said, "Nobody believes the fake story anymore. The world can see through the fakery."

The Kerala Congress also posted an image of a beer mug showing the Indian economy as the actual liquid and the official GDP numbers as fizz.

Akhilesh questions past irregularities as Ram temple trust appoints CEO

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Lucknow, September 2

Samajwadi Party president Akhilesh Yadav on Wednesday reacted to the appointment of a full-time chief executive officer for the Ram temple, saying new developments cannot erase questions surrounding alleged irregularities in the temple's affairs.

The Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust appointed former Air Marshal Jitendra Mishra as the temple's first full-time CEO at a meeting in Ayodhya on Wednesday.

Reacting to the appointment, Yadav said, "Will new things make us forget the old things? We have no complaints against anyone."

The former Uttar Pradesh chief minister also raised allegations concerning donations made to the Ram temple. He alleged that ordinary employees were sent to jail in connection with the alleged theft

Kuki MLAs return to Manipur Assembly after 3 years of conflict

Assembly adopts resolution urging Centre to update National Register of Citizens before census in state

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Imphal, September 2

Kuki MLAs on Wednesday attended a session of the Manipur Assembly in Imphal for the first time since ethnic strife erupted in the state over three years ago, officials said.

Saikul MLA Kimne Hoakip Hangshing of Kuki Peoples' Alliance (KPA) and Independent legislator Haokholet Kipgen of Saitu seat attended the first day of the session, they said.

Both the MLAs are from Kangpokpi district.

Deputy Chief Minister Nemcha Kipgen also attended the session virtually.

Chief Minister Y Khemchand Singh described the development as a "positive step toward fostering unity and peace in the state", an official statement said.



Manipur Chief Minister Yumnam Khemchand Singh, in Imphal, Wednesday

PTI

"This is a good sign from people's representatives, and it is a welcome step... With collective efforts, Manipur can strive to walk the path to peace," he said.

Singh attributed the development to the state government's persistent efforts to address and reduce the trust deficit among various

communities.

He also reiterated his administration's commitment to inclusive dialogue and reconciliation.

Earlier, Kuki Inpi Manipur (KIM), the apex body of the Kukis, had directed all MLAs from the community not to travel to Meitei-majority Imphal to attend the Assembly session scheduled to begin on Wednesday, pending a political settlement on the Kuki-Zo demand for a separate administration.

In February, six Kuki-Zo MLAs attended the Budget session of the Manipur Assembly virtually.

More than 260 people have been killed and thousands rendered homeless in ethnic violence between Imphal Valley-based Meiteis and adjoining hills-based Kukis since May 2023.

'Chhatron Ki Goonj in Indore postponed'

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Indore, September 2

The Congress on Wednesday said that party leader Rahul Gandhi's 'Chhatron Ki Goonj' event, scheduled for September 12 in Indore, has been postponed to September 19 due to denial of permission to hold the programme at a city-based stadium.

The ruling Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) rejected the Congress' argument, saying that under an old order of the Madhya

Pradesh High Court, only sports activities or state-level government events are permitted at the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium.

While the Opposition party accused the BJP of denying permission as it was "scared" of Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi's upcoming event, the saffron party hit back, saying the grand old party was giving excuses in order to hide its failure to draw people to the programme.

State Congress president Jitu Patwari said that

after the state government refused to provide the Nehru Stadium, the 'Chhatron Ki Goonj' event will now be held on September 19 instead of September 12.

Making an announcement during a meeting regarding preparations for the event in Indore, he said the Congress will now find a new venue and make arrangements accordingly.

The Congress is trying to mobilise 50,000 students from Indore and surrounding areas for the 'Chhatron Ki Goonj' programme.

Bihar launches door-to-door health campaign

Patna, 02 September

Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary on Wednesday launched the 'Jaanch Evam Upchar - Chikitsa Aapke Dwar' Campaign at Urja Auditorium, Rajvanshi Nagar, Patna. On the occasion, he flagged off awareness raths for all 38 districts of the state. The campaign will run from September 2 to November 30, 2026.

Addressing the programme, the Chief Minister congratulated the Health Department for organising the event. He said the campaign has been launched under the guidance of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Health minister JP Nadda. In Bihar, Health minister Nishant Kumar is overseeing this work. The objective of the campaign is to ensure timely detection and treatment rather than waiting for an illness to become serious. "Get screened so that you do not fall ill in the first place. Only when a disease is identified in time can correct and effective treatment be possible," he said. Under the campaign, citizens above 30 years of age will be screened. Health workers will conduct primary examinations and counselling door-to-door, and as required, patients will be provided treatment facilities ranging from Ayushman Arogya Mandir to the district hospital.

The campaign will screen for diabetes, blood pressure, common cancers, heart disease, respiratory and lung diseases, and fatty liver.

The Chief Minister said health services in the state are being steadily strengthened. Patient referrals from hospitals have declined and the number of surgeries at district hospitals has increased.

TO FACILITATE REDRESSAL OF GRIEVANCES OF PERSONS WITH DISABILITIES

HALSA launches initiatives to strengthen access to justice

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, September 2

In a significant step towards making justice more accessible, inclusive and citizen-centric, Justice Deepak Sibal, Judge, Punjab and Haryana High Court and Executive Chairman, Haryana State Legal Services Authority (HALSA) on Wednesday launched two major initiatives "Nyay Mitra - Justice at Your Doorstep" and an Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for Complaint Redressal, Legal Aid and Protection of Persons with Disabilities, including Prisoners with Disabilities.

KEY POINTS

- » The two initiatives reaffirm HALSA's commitment to the vision of "Access to Justice for All" by taking legal services closer to citizens
- » Under "Nyay Mitra - Justice at Your Doorstep", Justice Deepak Sibal flagged off four Mobile Legal Services Vans, conceived as mobile extensions of Legal Services Institutions to provide last-mile access to justice

The two initiatives reaffirm HALSA's commitment to the vision of "Access to Justice for All" by taking legal services closer to citizens and strengthening institutional mechanisms for protection of vulnerable persons.

Under "Nyay Mitra - Justice at Your Doorstep", Justice Deepak Sibal flagged off four Mobile Legal Services Vans, conceived as mobile extensions of Legal Services Institutions to provide last-mile access to justice.

The vehicles will operate as Mobile Legal Services Clinics through planned 'Justice Circuits' covering the entire State. Special focus will be given to remote and difficult-to-access villages, rural areas, aspirational blocks, industrial clusters, educational institutions and other underserved areas.

The Mobile Legal Services Vans will provide citizens with free legal aid, legal guidance, pre-litigation counselling, assistance in victim compensation claims, ADR services, Tele-Law consultations and assistance in accessing welfare schemes.

They will also undertake legal awareness and legal literacy activities, particularly for women, children, senior citizens, industrial workers and other vulnerable sections.

The mobile teams will be supported by Panel Advocates, Para Legal Volunteers and other stakeholders, to ensure effective assistance as well as follow-up.

On the same occasion, Justice Deepak Sibal launched an SOP for Complaint Redressal, Legal Aid and Protection of Persons with Disabilities, including Prisoners with Disabilities, aimed at establishing a uni-

form, accessible, rights-based and accountable mechanism for addressing complaints relating to abuse, violence and exploitation.

The SOP gives practical effect to Section 7 of the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016, and seeks to ensure that such complaints are treated as matters involving statutory rights rather than being trivialised as private or interpersonal or family disputes.

It emphasises free and timely legal aid, institutional coordination and sustained legal awareness and capacity-building.

EDITORIAL

Beyond the Capacity Race

India's renewable energy transition has reached an unusual contradiction. The country is adding solar capacity at remarkable speed even as significant quantities of clean electricity cannot be fully utilised. Nearly 11 terawatt-hours of solar generation was reportedly curtailed over the past 15 months as transmission constraints, inadequate storage and limited grid flexibility prevented available electricity from reaching consumers. This is particularly striking for an economy where power demand continues to rise rapidly. The problem exposes an important weakness in the way the energy transition has been measured. Installed capacity is an impressive headline number, but panels alone cannot deliver an energy transformation. Electricity must be transmitted, balanced and available when consumers need it. India has built the generation engine; the infrastructure surrounding that engine must now catch up.

Solar electricity presents an inherent challenge because generation rises sharply during daylight hours and disappears after sunset, while demand follows a different curve. Storage can bridge this gap by absorbing electricity when supply exceeds immediate requirements and releasing it later. Yet India currently has only around 3 GW of battery storage against requirements projected to reach roughly 74 GW by 2032. Transmission poses another constraint. Much renewable capacity is located in resource-rich regions, while major consumption centres may be hundreds of kilometres away. New solar projects can also be completed faster than transmission networks required to evacuate their electricity. Unless storage facilities, interstate transmission corridors and grid-management systems expand alongside generation, curtailment could become a recurring feature rather than an occasional technical necessity.

The consequences extend beyond wasted electricity. Renewable projects depend on predictable revenues, and frequent curtailment can weaken their economics by leaving developers with generating assets that cannot consistently sell their output. Over time, that uncertainty can affect financing costs and investor confidence precisely when India requires enormous private investment to achieve its clean-energy ambitions. Recent efforts to strengthen Green Energy Corridors and encourage batteries alongside renewable projects therefore deserve urgency. Electricity markets can also become more flexible, rewarding consumers who shift some demand towards periods of abundant solar generation. Industries capable of scheduling energy-intensive operations during daylight hours could help absorb surplus electricity. Conventional plants, meanwhile, must become more responsive so generation can adjust efficiently as renewable supply fluctuates.

India's next phase of renewable development must consequently move beyond the race to install ever more capacity. Generation, transmission and storage need to be planned as parts of one electricity system rather than separate infrastructure exercises. Battery storage, pumped hydro, stronger transmission networks, better forecasting and more responsive electricity markets are no longer supporting components of the green transition; they are central to its success. Some renewable curtailment will remain unavoidable, particularly as variable energy becomes a larger part of the power mix. But routinely wasting usable clean electricity because infrastructure has fallen behind would represent a failure of planning. India has already demonstrated its ability to build solar power at extraordinary scale. The harder task now is ensuring that sunshine converted into electricity does not remain stranded.

LETTER



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Regional Responsibility

The devastating Nepal floods, with the death toll reaching 1,204, underline the terrifying human cost of extreme weather. Beyond immediate rescue and relief, Nepal needs sustained assistance for rehabilitation and rebuilding. The tragedy also demands stronger early-warning systems, resilient infrastructure and greater regional cooperation against worsening climate disasters.

AARAV SHARMA,
DELHI

You can also send your comments to The Editor, Millennium Post, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

Building Pathways to Dignity

Vonisha's journey shows how listening to communities and adapting interventions can turn education, skills and support into sustainable opportunities

NEXUS OF GOOD



ANIL SWARUP

THE WRITER IS AN AUTHOR AND A FORMER CIVIL SERVANT

Vonisha Service Foundation, a Section 8 not-for-profit organisation, was established in April 2017 to work with underprivileged children and marginalised women. From the beginning, there was a belief that poverty and exclusion cannot be addressed through a single intervention. Education without health, skills without livelihood opportunities, or empowerment without dignity can only provide partial solutions. An integrated approach was adopted across Education, Skills, Health, Sports and Environment. Vonisha gave a presentation on its recent activities at an event organised by the Bengaluru Chapter of Nexus of Good.

The approach was simple. Sustainable social impact begins by listening to people, understanding their circumstances and responding to their actual needs. The early work focused on children who had dropped out of school,

particularly those living in vulnerable communities around Bengaluru. An attempt was made to help them bridge educational gaps and enrol in government schools or affordable English-medium schools, according to their parents' aspirations.

Getting children into school was only the beginning. Many returned to the same environment and dropped out again. The teachers went into the communities, found them and brought them back. During the first year, there were just three teachers who engaged with 50 out-of-school children. Another barrier was soon discovered. Parents wanted their older children to attend school, but at the same time, they wanted them to take care of their younger siblings. So, this led to the older children dropping out to take care of their younger siblings. We responded by starting a day-care centre for the younger siblings. That simple intervention improved attendance and retention.

COVID-19 became another defining moment. The organisation stayed connected with the families. They were served and provided dry ration support worth about ₹1,000 per family during the uncertainty. After the pandemic, something changed. Children who earlier had to be encouraged to attend began coming in large numbers. Their experience created trust. Demand grew. Additional space was rented. More teachers were recruited. What began as a small educational initiative grew into an engagement supporting around 250 children.

Across the education and livelihood initiatives, the numbers reflect this journey of growth. Close to 5,000



Getting children into school was only the beginning of a long journey

NEARLY 5,000 LEARNERS MAINSTREAMED, WHILE 500 WOMEN RECEIVED LIVELIHOOD SKILLS

first-generation learners were mainstreamed, bringing them back into school and giving them a foothold in formal education. Livelihood skills were imparted to 500 women, an effort that, in turn, led us to think more deeply about what sustainable livelihood really means for them and eventually shaped Project VISILITES.

The engagement with women followed a similar journey of learning and adaptation. During community surveys in peri-urban areas, interactions with migrant families took place. In many households, the man was the primary breadwinner, while women remained at home because of

family responsibilities, though they wanted to contribute to the family income.

Free, structured four-month tailoring programmes across these communities were started. It was initially believed that training would naturally lead to employment. However, a six-month review revealed otherwise. Many women could not work every day because of responsibilities at home. Available employment did not fit their circumstances. Instead of treating the programme as successful because many women had been trained, the organisation was confronted with a more important question: what kind of work will actually work for these women?

That question led to Project VISILITES, Vonisha Inclusive Skills & Leadership Initiative for Women through Training. Empowerment & Sustainability. Genuine market needs were identified. Working women, families and communities needed reliable tailoring and garment alteration services, while trained women were looking for flexible livelihood opportunities.

An attempt was made to connect the two.

Skill meets Need.

VISILITES brings together trained women, a refurbished solar-powered mobile tailoring unit and an app-based order management system. Women receive a minimum guaranteed payment along with a work-linked variable component. The mobile unit can travel to corporate offices, residential communities, apartments and other locations where alteration orders are aggregated.

Customers can view services, place orders and make online payments. Feedback is collected to improve the service. VISILITES is more than a tailoring project. It makes women's empowerment practical by connecting skills with market demand.

The work of the organisation extends beyond these initiatives. Through the Vonisha Skill Enhancement Project, English communication and life skills training are also provided. In Tamil Nadu, a Miyawaki forest has also been created on a government school campus at Vayapatti village in Theni district, linking community development with environmental responsibility.

At Vonisha, the aspiration is not merely to serve communities. It is to create opportunities that help people become more confident, skilled, independent and capable of shaping a better future for themselves and their families by bridging gaps and unlocking potential.

What has been attempted under Vonisha is a small beginning that has already travelled some distance. It is a wonderful model of Nexus of Good. This model can be replicated and scaled through public-private partnerships.

Views expressed are personal

Navigating Turbulent Waters

Deeper US ties offer opportunities, but India must keep its strategic options open

ECONOMIC ODYSSEY



SHISHIR PRIYADARSHI

THE WRITER IS PRESIDENT, CHINTAN RESEARCH FOUNDATION AND FORMER DIRECTOR, WTO

For most of the post-Cold War era, the global economy offered countries a reasonably clear map. Trade expanded, supply chains lengthened, capital crossed borders with increasing ease and economic interdependence was regarded as a force for stability. Today, that map is being redrawn. Tariffs have returned as instruments of economic statecraft, technology is increasingly securitised, energy flows are shaped by geopolitics and the distinction between economic and strategic interests has become difficult to sustain.

Homer's *Odyssey* provides a surprisingly contemporary metaphor. Odysseus's voyage from Troy to Ithaca was disrupted by storms, temptations, hostile forces and choices in which there was rarely a perfect answer. India's economic journey is rather similar. The desti-

nation may be clear – a larger, stronger and more globally integrated economy – but the waters are becoming considerably more turbulent.

US Trade Talks and the Larger Strategic Game

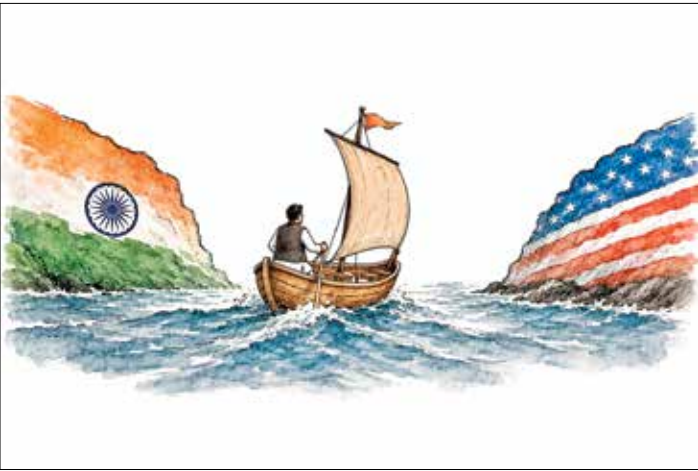
The latest developments in India-US economic relations illustrate the point. The two countries have reached an interim understanding that significantly reduces the tariff burden on Indian exports to the US, while envisaging substantial increases in India's purchases of American goods, energy and technology. Yet translating that understanding into market access, sectoral commitments and a durable framework continues. The Indian Commerce Ministry has been consulting exporters and industry on specific market-access issues ahead of further engagement with Washington.

The relationship now encompasses energy, technology, investment, critical supply chains, defence and, increasingly, how much strategic autonomy each side is prepared to preserve. New Delhi's challenge is not to choose between the United States and everyone else. It is to deepen economic ties with Washington sufficiently to capture the opportunities they offer without allowing that relationship to determine every other element of India's foreign and economic policy.

Between Scylla and Charybdis

One of the more famous episodes in the *Odyssey* is Odysseus's passage between Scylla and Charybdis. He cannot avoid danger altogether; he can only choose the course that minimises damage.

India faces its own version of that choice. On one side lies the enormous opportunity pre-



India's larger economic Odyssey has only just begun

INDIA'S ANSWER TO GLOBAL UNCERTAINTY CANNOT BE AUTARKY

sented by the United States: the world's largest consumer market, a technology powerhouse and a potentially transformative source of investment and innovation. On the other are the realities of India's energy security, defence requirements and established relationships with countries such as Russia and Iran.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi's recent meetings with Russian President Vladimir Putin and Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian at the SCO summit in Bishkek make this evident, underscoring India's continuing economic and strategic relationships beyond Washington.

From Washington's perspective, these relationships can appear difficult to reconcile with a deepening US-India

partnership. From New Delhi's perspective, they are part of a global strategy based on multi-alignment. India cannot afford to gain strategic partnership at the cost of strategic independence.

No Sirens of Easy Choices

The *Odyssey*'s Sirens offer another economic lesson. Today's seductive propositions are that one market can replace another, one strategic partnership can solve multiple vulnerabilities, or economic security can be achieved by retreating behind tariff walls. None is entirely credible.

India's answer to global uncertainty cannot be autarky. Nor can it be excessive dependence on any single market, technology ecosystem, energy source or geopolitical partner. The lesson is diversification – of markets, supply chains, technology partnerships and energy sources – while simultaneously building domestic capabilities.

India's recent growth performance therefore matters. The economy grew 7.8% in the April-June quarter of FY2026-

27, while gross fixed capital formation increased to 34.3% of GDP. A stronger domestic engine gives New Delhi greater room to negotiate internationally without approaching trade talks from a position of vulnerability.

The Destination is Ithaca

The *Odyssey* offers one final lesson: Odysseus never loses sight of Ithaca. India too needs a clear destination. Trade policy should not merely seek the lowest possible tariff in the next negotiation, nor should foreign policy be reduced to managing the immediate reaction of one partner or another. The larger objective must be an economy that is productive, competitive, technologically capable and resilient enough to prosper regardless of which way the geopolitical winds blow.

That requires India to integrate more deeply with the world, not less. But integration must be accompanied by diversification and domestic capability. The country needs American technology and capital, European markets and technology, Russian energy where economically rational, Gulf investment and connectivity, and deeper economic relationships across Asia, Africa and Latin America. The point is not to sail away from every storm. It is to become a better sailor.

The successful countries will not be those that find a permanently safe harbour. They will be those capable of navigating between competing currents while keeping their destination firmly in sight. For India, the US trade talks are one important part of that voyage. The larger *Odyssey* has only just begun.

Views expressed are personal

India's Next Nutritional Chapter

Our nation's nutrition challenge demands a shift from simply filling plates to understanding balance, diversity, individual needs and informed food choices

ILLNESS TO WELLNESS



ANIL RAJPUT

THE WRITER IS THE CHAIRPERSON, ADVISORY COUNCIL, ILLNESS TO WELLNESS FOUNDATION

What if one of India's biggest nutrition challenges is not an empty plate, but a full one that still fails to nourish? Hunger is easy to recognise. Poor nutrition can be far harder to see. A child may eat every day and still not receive the variety of nutrients needed for healthy growth and development. An adult may never miss a meal and yet follow a diet that is repetitive, unbalanced or poorly matched to the body's needs. This is why nutrition cannot be judged simply by how much food is on the plate. The more important question is what that food is doing for our health.

As India observes National Nutrition Week from 1 to 7 September, the country already has an important foundation of public awareness. POSHAN Abhiyaan has used a Jan Andolan approach to make nutrition a community conversation, while Poshan Maah, Poshan Pakhwada and FSSAI's Eat Right School take nutrition education into communities and classrooms. More than 150 crore activities have been undertaken under the Jan Andolan since 2018. These efforts matter because nutrition education is not a one-week exercise. Its real success lies in whether awareness becomes everyday practice.

That begins with understanding what malnutrition actually means. The word is often used as though it refers only to a visibly underfed person. In reality, the World Health Organisation defines malnutrition broadly as deficiencies, excesses or imbalances in nutrient intake or use. Undernutrition is one part of it. In children, it can appear as wasting, where weight is too low for height, stunting, where height is too low for age, or being underweight for age. Deficiencies of essential vitamins and minerals may also exist without the obvious signs commonly associated with hunger. A person can therefore have regular access to food and still be poorly nourished.

The distinction between a full plate and a balanced plate is therefore crucial. A full plate tells us about quantity. A balanced plate tells us about variety and proportion. ICMR-National Institute of Nutrition's "My Plate for the Day" brings together cereals and millets, vegetables, fruits, pulses or other protein sources, milk or curd, nuts and seeds, along with appropriate fats and oils. The precise meal need not look identical across India. A household in Kerala, Rajasthan, Punjab, Assam or Tamil Nadu can achieve balance through completely different foods. India does not need one national menu. It needs a national understanding of balance.

That understanding must recognise that there is no single nutritional prescription for every person. Requirements change through childhood, adolescence, adulthood and older age. They



The focus must move from eating enough to understanding what genuinely nourishes the body

INDIA DOES NOT NEED ONE NATIONAL MENU. IT NEEDS A NATIONAL UNDERSTANDING OF BALANCE

are also influenced by height and overall body size, body composition, biological sex, physical activity, health status and physiological stages such as pregnancy and lactation. The nature of one's work matters too. Someone performing sustained manual labour may have very different overall food and energy requirements from someone whose working day is largely sedentary. Metabolic rate also differs between individuals, influenced by factors such as age, body size, lean body mass and physiology.

Environment adds another dimension. Extreme heat, cold or high altitude can affect appetite, hydration, energy expenditure and physiological adaptation. Someone undertaking strenuous outdoor work in the mountains cannot automatically be expected to have the same requirements as a person leading a largely sedentary life at sea level. This does not mean that everyone needs a complicated customised diet. It means that good nutrition must recognise human variation. Research on extreme environments similarly shows that heat, cold and altitude can alter physiological and nutritional demands.

The same nuance is needed when we talk about salt, sugars and fats. Nutrition should not reduce entire nutrients to simple

labels of "good" or "bad". Fats perform essential functions and help the body absorb certain vitamins. Sodium is necessary for normal physiological function, while sugars occur naturally in foods such as fruit and milk. The concern is excess, particularly when added sugars, excess salt or less healthy fats become routine and displace more nourishing foods. Public-health guidance to limit such excess remains important even though overall food, fluid and nutrient requirements differ. Heavy physical work, intense exercise, substantial sweating, climate and certain medical conditions can alter particular needs, which is why special requirements should be considered in context rather than assumed from a universal formula. ICMR-NIN's dietary guidance similarly distinguishes between the physiological role of nutrients and the problems created by excessive consumption or poor dietary patterns.

This is especially relevant in Indian homes, where food is deeply connected with affection, hospitality and celebration. The objective should not be to turn meals into calculations or make people anxious about every ingredient. It should be to understand the overall pattern of eating. Dal with a grain, vegetables and greens, curd, fruit, nuts, seeds, millets, eggs or other locally appropriate foods can contribute in different ways. No single ingredient needs to become a miracle food, and no occasional indulgence should define an entire diet. What matters is what we repeatedly choose over time.

There is also much that modern India can learn from its own civilisational understanding of food. Indian thought gave food a place far beyond mere consumption. The Taaittiriya Upanishad accords anna,

or food, profound significance, while the Bhagavad Gita, through the idea of yuktahara, associates well-being with moderation in eating alongside balance in activity, rest and daily conduct. The enduring insight is not a nutritional formula. It is the principle that health is difficult to sustain through extremes.

Ayurvedic traditions expressed a related idea through Ritucharya, or adapting aspects of diet and daily routine to seasonal change. Modern nutrition science and traditional systems should not be confused with one another, and historical ideas should not replace evidence-based medical advice. Yet the philosophy beneath Ritucharya remains valuable. Human beings do not live separately from climate, season, geography and availability. Food habits can respond intelligently to those realities rather than becoming detached from them.

India's regional cuisines offer a living illustration of that adaptability. Millets acquired importance in landscapes suited to their cultivation. Pulses and grains became partners in countless preparations. Fermentation became part of food traditions in several regions, while vegetables, greens, fruits, curd, buttermilk, nuts and seeds entered meals according to local availability and custom. Not every traditional practice should automatically be treated as nutritionally superior, but our food inheritance reminds us that diversity, locality and adaptation have long been part of the Indian relationship with nourishment.

There is a deeper civilisational lesson as well. Nutrition is partly a matter of knowledge, but also of self-mastery. Appetite is natural, convenience has value, and celebration and indulgence have an

important place in social life. The challenge is to prevent the occasional from becoming habitual and convenience from replacing conscious choice. Knowledge about health becomes meaningful only when it changes conduct. Restraint need not mean deprivation. It can mean having the judgement to choose what serves us well most of the time.

That judgement must be taught early. Children learn about food long before they encounter formal nutrition education. They observe what adults eat, what is cooked at home and how meals are shared. They should learn why a plate needs variety, where food comes from, how simple meals are prepared, why regional and seasonal foods matter, and why one person's requirements may differ from another's. Comparing children simply by height, build or appetite is not enough to determine whether they are adequately nourished. Growth must be understood in relation to age and appropriate health assessment.

Japan's Shokuiku approach offers a useful international lesson. It uses food and school meals as part of education, helping children understand dietary habits, food production and the relationship between eating and health. India already possesses enormous cultural knowledge about food and nationwide school and nutrition platforms. The opportunity is to make food literacy a basic life skill. A young person who leaves school knowing mathematics, science and history but unable to recognise the foundations of a balanced meal has missed knowledge that will matter every day.

This is where organisations such as the Illness to Wellness Foundation can make an important contribution. Prevention begins long before a diagnosis. It begins in homes, schools, workplaces, markets and ordinary meals. Awareness should help people recognise undernutrition, understand changing nutritional needs and know when professional guidance is necessary.

National Nutrition Week should therefore leave us with a more thoughtful question than "Have I eaten enough?" We should ask: "Am I giving my body what it needs for the life I lead?"

India's next chapter in nutrition will not be written by filling plates alone. It will be written when we understand those plates, respect the different needs of the people eating from them, teach future generations how to make informed choices, and combine modern nutritional science with the enduring civilisational values of balance, moderation and respect for food. A well-nourished India begins not simply with more food, but with a better understanding of nourishment.

Views expressed are personal

Teaching Beyond the Textbook

AI literacy must equip students to question, verify and think independently alongside intelligent machines; writes Ritik Kumar

Artificial intelligence is rapidly changing the environment in which young Indians will study, work and make decisions. The preparation of revised NCERT textbooks for Classes 10 to 12 therefore comes at an important moment. Schools cannot remain insulated from technologies that students are already encountering through search engines, writing assistants, image generators and educational platforms. Introducing AI concepts into the curriculum can help pupils understand the systems increasingly shaping their world. But adding a chapter on artificial intelligence will not, by itself, make education ready for the AI age. The more fundamental challenge is to decide what students should be capable of doing when machines can instantly generate essays, solve problems, summarise information and imitate human creativity.

Education must consequently move from merely providing information towards strengthening judgement.

That begins with verification. Generative AI can produce convincing answers that are incomplete, misleading or simply wrong. Students accustomed to accepting polished responses without questioning their accuracy could become more informed in appearance while becoming less capable of independent thought. Schools must therefore teach pupils how to interrogate sources, distinguish evidence from assertion, identify bias and compare machine-generated claims with reliable information. These abilities were important before AI; they are indispensable now. Classroom assignments should evolve accordingly. If an essay can be produced in seconds, assessment cannot depend exclusively on the finished essay. Teachers

STUDENTS MUST UNDERSTAND PRIVACY, PLAGIARISM, COPYRIGHT AND ALGORITHMIC BIAS

can increasingly examine how students reached conclusions, which evidence they selected, how they defended arguments and whether they can recognise weaknesses in an AI-generated response.

Responsible use must form another pillar of AI education. Students need to understand privacy, plagiarism, copyright, algorithmic bias and the consequences of uploading personal or confidential information to digital platforms. They should

also learn that using AI as an assistant is different from surrendering intellectual effort to it. Blanket bans are unlikely to work when these tools are becoming embedded across professional life. Equally, unrestricted use risks turning technology into a substitute for learning. Schools need clear age-appropriate rules defining when AI can support research, brainstorming or experimentation and when students must demonstrate their own knowledge. Teachers themselves will require sustained training, because no curriculum can succeed if educators are expected to supervise technologies they have not been adequately prepared to understand.

India must also guard against allowing AI education to deepen existing inequalities. A student in a well-equipped urban school may have access to sophisticated tools, reliable connectivity and trained

teachers, while another may struggle with basic digital infrastructure. AI literacy cannot become another advantage determined by geography or income. Public schools require connectivity, devices, teacher support and accessible learning resources alongside revised textbooks. Ultimately, preparing children for an AI-driven economy is not about teaching them to compete with machines at tasks machines perform efficiently. It is about developing qualities technology cannot replace easily: curiosity, reasoning, creativity, ethical judgement and the ability to ask better questions. The strongest education system will not produce students who merely know how to use AI. It will produce students who know when to trust it, when to challenge it and when to think for themselves.

Views expressed are personal

1,528 EVACUATED FROM FLOOD-AFFECTED AREAS

UP: 22 districts flood-hit, rain-related incidents kill 3

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Lucknow, September 2

Three people, including an 18-month-old boy, died in rain-related incidents in Uttar Pradesh on Wednesday even as the state government said it has evacuated 1,528 people from flood-affected areas and deployed hundreds of boats, flood posts and medical teams for relief operations.

In a statement, the government said 32 districts have been affected by floods so far, with the situation currently prevailing in 22 districts. A total of 742 flood posts, 452 boats and motorboats and 225 medical teams were active on Tuesday, while 2,460 people were staying in 105 relief shelters.

It said Ayodhya, Azamgarh, Ballia, Barabanki, Badaun, Chandauli, Chitrakoot, Farrukhabad, Ghazi- pur, Gorakhpur, Hapur, Hardoi, Kasganj, Lakhim- pur Kheri, Mirzapur, Mora- dabad, Prayagraj, Sant Kabir Nagar, Shahjahan- pur, Sitapur, Unnao and Varanasi were impacted by floods. In Pratapgarh, 18-month-old Priyansh died after being trapped under debris when a kutcha house collapsed amid continuous rain in Chhoti Kothariya vil- lage, police said.

In Amroha's Gajraula, two people -- Shera (32) and Suresh (55) -- were killed after the roof projection of a shop collapsed during



An aerial view shows a residential area inundated by floodwaters after the Pandu river overflowed into low-lying localities, at Barra 8, in Kanpur, Wednesday PTI

KEY POINTS

- » In Pratapgarh, 18-month-old Priyansh died after being trapped under debris when a kutcha house collapsed amid continuous rain in Chhoti Kothariya village, police said
- » In Amroha's Gajraula, two people -- Shera (32) and Suresh (55) -- were killed after the roof projection of a shop col- lapsed during heavy rain

heavy rain.

Sub-Divisional Magis- trate Shailesh Dubey said the cause was being investi- gated to determine whether the structure collapsed due to rain or its dilapidated condition.

In Chitrakoot, author- ities rescued around 150 people trapped by a sud- den swelling of the Manda- kini river in Chaura village. The 42nd Battalion

PAC's flood-relief pla- toon, with support from local administration, used motorboats to rescue those trapped. Food, relief mate- rial and medical assistance were also provided to the affected.

Ballia remained among the worst affected dis- tricts, with rising Ganga and Saryu waters affecting around 20,500 people in villages and urban localities

of Sadar, Bairia and Bans- dih tehsils. Eighty-three boats are being operated for relief and rescue.

The district adminis- tration has distributed 6,500 ration kits, 33,843 medicine kits and 83,092 packets of cooked food. It has also vaci- nated 16,629 livestock and distributed 965 quintals of fodder. Flood shelters and community kitchens are functioning at Gopalnagar Tadi and Bhojpurwa.

Flood posts are active, and National Disaster Response Force and Provin- cial Armed Constabulary teams have been deployed. Officials and medical teams are visiting affected areas daily, while generators are being used to maintain electricity supply where required.

AMONG THEM, BANKS AND RAILWAYS TOP CHART

CVC report: 70,584 corruption complaints received against govt depts in 2025

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 2

More than 70,500 cor- ruption complaints were received against govern- ment bodies last year, with banks and the Railways top- ping the chart, according to a report by the Central Vig- ilance Commission (CVC).

Out of the 70,584 com- plaints received by the chief vigilance officers (CVOs) -- who act as the distant arm of the Commission -- 64,905 were disposed of as on December 31, 2025, the report said.

"The remaining 5,679 complaints were under process at the end of 2025, including 2,002 for more than three months," the CVC annual report 2025 said.

The CVOs are expected to complete investigations

'THE COMMISSION CONDUCTS A PERI- ODICAL REVIEW OF COMPLAINTS PENDING WITH THE CVOs TO ENSURE THEIR EXPEDI- TIOUS DISPOSAL'

within three months.

The Commission con- ducts a periodical review of complaints pending with the CVOs to ensure their expeditious disposal, the report said. A maximum of 9,933 complaints were received by the CVOs of banks, of which 9,520 were disposed of and 413 were pending, includ- ing 52 for more than three months, it said.

The CVOs received 9,381 complaints related to the

Railways, of which 8,754 were disposed of and 627 were pending (10 for more than three months), as on December 31, 2025, the report said. A total of 6,531 complaints were related to housing and urban affairs and 4,834 were against local bodies except the Govern- ment of National Capital Ter- ritory of Delhi (GNCTD).

The local bodies include Delhi Jal Board (DJB), Delhi State Industrial and Infra- structure Development Corporation Ltd (DSI- IDC), Delhi Transco Lim- ited (DTL), Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC), Delhi Urban Shelter Improve- ment Board (DUSIB), Delhi Tourism and Transportation Development Corporation (DTTDC), Municipal Cor- poration of Delhi (MCD), and the New Delhi Municipal

Council (NDMC). As many as 4,118 complaints received last year were related to employees working in the coal sector, 3,107 in finance, 2,804 against Delhi govern- ment and 2,722 related to the petroleum ministry, according to the probity watchdog's report, which was made public recently.

A total of 2,633 com- plaints were against Delhi Police, 2,139 against road transport and highways, and 2,036 related to the Ministry of Home Affairs, excluding Delhi Police, it said.

There were 2,030 cor- ruption complaints against human resource develop- ment, 1,894 against the labour ministry, 1,536 against insurance compa- nies while 1,469 were related to telecommunication, the report said.

Kargil gets second passport seva kendra

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Kargil/Jammu, September 2

Union Minister of State for External Affairs Kirti Var- dan Singh and Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Sax- ena on Wednesday inaugu- rated a post office passport seva kendra (POPSK) here, expanding passport ser- vices closer to people in the remote district and adjoining areas.

The POPSK, established by the Ministry of External Affairs in association with the Department of Posts at the sub-post office, Kargil, is the second passport seva kendra in Ladakh after Leh and the 457th POPSK in the



country, officials said.

The facility fulfils a long- pending demand of Kargil residents, who earlier had to travel to Leh and Sri- nagar for passport-related services, officials said.

Its establishment is expected to reduce the time, travel and expendi- ture involved in obtaining passports and particularly benefit people travelling

abroad for education and employment as well as those undertaking Haj and Umrah pilgrimages to Saudi Arabia, they said.

Speaking at the inau- guration, Saxena said the new centre is another step towards ensuring last-mile delivery of citizen-centric services in Ladakh and bringing essential govern- ment services closer to people in remote and geo- graphically challenging areas. He thanked Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the Ministry of External Affairs and the Department of Posts for fulfilling the long-pend- ing aspiration of the people of Kargil.

Chhattisgarh ranks first in 'Catch the Rain' campaign



OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 2

Chhattisgarh has emerged as a national leader in rain- water harvesting and water conservation, securing the top position in the third phase of the Ministry of Jal Shakti's 'Jal Sanchay Jan Bhagidari' (JSJB) and 'Catch the Rain' campaigns.

Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai presented the state's water conserva- tion efforts on a national platform during the Min- istry of Jal Shakti's depart- mental summit held at the Sushma Swaraj Bhawan in New Delhi, in the presence of Prime Minister Naren- dra Modi.

During the 'Catch the Rain' session of the summit, Deputy Chief Minister Arun Sao shared details regard- ing rainwater harvesting, groundwater recharge, and the conservation of drink- ing water sources.

At the summit, the Chief Minister presented Chhattisgarh's public partici- pation-driven water conservation model and proposed four measures to conserve every drop of rainwater across the coun- try: state-specific 'Catch the Rain' plans, 'State Water Awards' to recognise high-performing states, map- ping of water structures through BISAG-N, and quar- terly reviews chaired by the Chief Secretary.

NF Railway GM meets Manipur Guv and CM

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Maligaon, September 2

General Manager of N F Railway, Chetan Kumar Shrivastava called on the Governor of Manipur, Ajay Kumar Bhalla, at Lok Bhavan, Manipur, on Tuesday.

During the meeting, discussions were held on strengthening rail connectivity in the state, improving passenger convenience and freight move- ment, enhancing security infrastructure and further advancing Railway ser- vices and infrastructure in Manipur.

Chetan Kumar Shriv- astava also met the Chief Minister of Manipur, Yum- nam Khemchand Singh, at the CM Secretariat.



Briefs

Haryana govt misled: Hooda

CHANDIGARH: For- mer Chief Minister and Leader of the Opposition Bhupinder Singh Hooda stated that while he has served as an MP and MLA many times, he had never witnessed the kind of mistreat- ment endured during this monsoon session.

Addressing a spe- cial press conference at his residence, Hooda remarked that the BJP did nothing but lie and mislead the House throughout the session.

Toll fraud: ED searches 14 locations

NEW DELHI: The Enforcement Director- ate (ED) on Wednes- day conducted search at 14 different prem- ises in the state of Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, Maharashtra, Jammu, MP, NCR and Kolkata in connection with the alleged commission of toll collection fraud involving National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) toll plaza.

CBI to probe Disha Salian case

MUMBAI: The Bom- bay High Court on Wednesday ordered a CBI probe into the death of Disha Salian, former manager of late actor Sushant Singh Rajput, and pulled up the Mum- bai Police for failing to register an FIR for six years, observing that their probe "raises more questions than answers".

'Independence was not gifted but won through mass movement'



OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, 2 September

Former Union Min- ister of State for External Affairs, journalist and author MJ Akbar speak- ing at the Bharat Ki Soch dialogue titled, "Shedding our Colonial Vestiges for a Viksit Bharat" in New Delhi argued that "decol- onisation should restore India's civilisational con- fidence while subjecting both inherited and indig- enous ideas to the test of evidence, relevance and justice."

Akbar argued that true modernity rests on democ- racy, freedom of faith and speech, the elimination

of poverty, and gender equality, and that India's progress on these fronts forms the real foundation of its development story. This dialogue was a part of Bharat Ki Soch's Mantra series which is Bharat Ki Soch's policy dialogue initiative connecting Indian civilisational thought with contemporary public policy questions

Highlighting the achievements of India's freedom struggle, Akbar pointed out that India evicted British rule while deliberately retaining and reinventing the English language as its own, even as it rejected the colonial fram- ing of "transfer of power."

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, September 2

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini said a detailed survey should be conducted to under- stand the background of less-educated youth and a report should be prepared and submitted.

Based on the findings, an effective action plan should be implemented for their holistic development.

Chief Minister Saini was chairing a meeting on Wednesday during which presentations were made on good practices adopted by various departments. Chief Secretary, Anurag Rastogi, Additional Chief Secretaries Sudhir Rajpal, Sumita Misra, G Anupama, AK Singh and Vijayendra Kumar, along with several other senior officers, were present at the meeting.

The Chief Minister was informed that under the skill development programme in prisons, Industrial Training Insti-



Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini presiding over a meeting, at Chandigarh MPOST

tutes (ITIs) are being run in five jails of the state to equip inmates with skills that would enable them to start their own liveli- hood ventures after their release. One-year train- ing has been provided in eight different trades, with 123 inmates having com- pleted their ITI courses. In addition, short-term vocational courses of up to three months are being conducted in 20 jails, in which 1,604 inmates have registered.

The meeting was informed that 3,321 inmates have also been

registered under the ULLAS programme in prisons for further education. Similarly, enrolments have been made under educa- tional programmes to provide education through IGNOU and NIOS.

It was further informed that, according to the educational profile of the prison population, there are 3,346 uneducated youth in various jails of the state. The Chief Min- ister directed that a detailed survey of such youth be conducted to ascertain the reasons behind their low level of education.

Punjab becomes first state to launch statewide digital portal 'Pehchaan'

For the digital identification of unknown and unclaimed deceased persons admitted to govt mortuaries

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, September 2

Punjab has become the first state in India to launch a statewide public identifica- tion portal, "Pehchaan", for the digital identification of unidentified and unclaimed deceased persons admitted to government mortuaries across the state.

The state-level portal was formally launched by Punjab Health and Fam- ily Welfare minister Balbir Singh here on Wednesday.

Under the 'Pehchaan' initiative, facial photo- graphs, permanent iden- tification marks including tattoos, birthmarks, and



deformities, and detailed physical descriptions of every unidentified, unclaimed deceased person will be uploaded to the portal within 48 hours of postmortem at any govern- ment mortuary in Punjab. The portal is publicly

accessible free of charge through all official web- sites of the Health Depart- ment and can be searched by families from anywhere in India or abroad.

Once a claimant submits an online claim, the con- cerned Investigating Offi-

cer is automatically notified to proceed with formal identification under com- petent legal authority with- out requiring families to visit mortuaries or police stations.

Describing the initia- tive as a moral and civilisa-

tional commitment, Balbir Singh said, "Every year, approximately 5,000 to 6,000 human beings die as unknown and unclaimed in Punjab alone. They were someone's son, daughter, spouse, or parent, and somewhere a family is still waiting for them. In our tra- dition, every soul is equal, and dignity is non-negotia- ble. No person, no matter how poor or migrant, will be denied the dignity of being found. The dignity of the dead is as much our responsibility as the health of the living, and Pehchaan ensures every family gets that crucial closure."

The Health Minister

noted that the portal is built on the robust foundation of Punjab's digital medico- legal software 'MedLeaPR', an NIC-built system devel- oped following Punjab and Haryana High Court directions.

Currently operational across all 23 districts and 346 government hospitals in the state with over 6,600 registered Medical Officers, MedLeaPR has recorded more than 12 lakh medico- legal and postmortem cases with a 99.6 per cent timely report freezing compliance rate.

Balbir Singh further highlighted that MedLeaPR connects police, courts,

health institutions, and nine forensic science laboratories—including AIIMS Bathinda—while maintain- ing active integration with the Crime and Criminal Tracking Network & Sys- tems (CCTNS) for cross- matching missing person records. Punjab's pioneer- ing medico-legal docu- mentation model has set a national benchmark, having been studied and adopted by nearly 30 States and Union Territo- ries across India.

The Health minister affirmed that the Pehchaan portal complies fully with the Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023.

News at a glance

America extends ban on flights to Haiti's capital

PORT-AU-PRINCE: The US Federal Aviation Administration has extended a ban on US flights to Haiti's capital until March as gang violence persists. The ban means that commercial operators and US registered civilian aircraft can't fly below 10,000 feet (around 3,000 metres) in Port-au-Prince and nearby areas, including parts of central Haiti. The FAA first halted such flights in November 2025 after gunmen shot at a Spirit Airlines flight as it was landing at Port-au-Prince's Toussaint Louverture International Airport.

Congo's Ebola outbreak shows no signs of slowing

BUNIA: Congo's Ebola outbreak has killed more than 3,000 people out of over 6,100 confirmed cases, the latest government data showed Wednesday, as the disease is spreading at an unprecedented speed, faster than efforts to track and slow it. Data from Congo's Ministry of Health showed the outbreak has recorded 6,186 confirmed cases, including 3,007 deaths since it was declared in mid-May. It remains the fastest-growing outbreak of Ebola ever.

Russian strikes kill two Ukrainian civilians

KYIV: Russian aerial attacks overnight and during daylight Wednesday killed two civilians and wounded six in the central Ukrainian city of Dnipro, local officials said, while the Kyiv and Odesa regions bore the brunt of Moscow's latest strikes. The air war between Russia and Ukraine has intensified as the conflict stretches into its fifth year following Moscow's invasion of its neighbour. The front line in eastern and southern Ukraine remains largely deadlocked, and US efforts to negotiate a settlement have yet to produce a path to peace.



U.S. Sen. Edward Markey, D-Mass., speaks after winning the Democratic nomination during a primary election night, in Boston

AP/PTI

Briefs

Xi visits Egypt

CAIRO: On the surface, Chinese President Xi Jinping's visit to Egypt this week is a run-of-the-mill opportunity for two countries to strengthen economic and diplomatic ties. But there is deep subtext to the meeting between Xi and President Abdel Fattah el-Sissi: China, the United States' top global rival, is cultivating an extensive relationship with one of America's key allies in the Middle East as it moves to expand its influence in the rapidly changing region. Xi aims to present China as a stabiliser in the region and contrast it with the United States.

22 killed in accident in Egypt

CAIRO: At least 22 people, including Egyptians and Jordanians, were killed Wednesday in a passenger bus crash in Egypt's Sinai Peninsula, authorities in both countries said. Twenty-eight others were injured.

The accident happened on a road linking the tourist resorts of Dahab and Nuweiba in South Sinai province, the Egyptian Health Ministry said in a statement.

The ministry said it deployed 20 ambulances to the scene to transport the dead and wounded to nearby hospitals. It didn't elaborate on the victims' nationalities.

US aircraft arrives in Thailand

LAEM CHABANG: The USS Abraham Lincoln aircraft carrier arrived in eastern Thailand early Wednesday after its gruelling deployment in the Middle East. Associated Press journalists watched the Lincoln, which is carrying about 5,000 service members, approach Laem Chabang port in Chonburi province shortly after the destroyer USS Frank E Petersen Jr sailed passed the area. The ship had been supporting the US war against Iran. Its deployment included a record-setting uninterrupted time at sea of more than 250 days. Concerns have grown about the Lincoln's lengthy deployment.

AMONG 4,216 MISSING PEOPLE, 583 ARE FOREIGNERS

Nepal flooding deaths surpass 1,200

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Kathmandu, September 2

The death toll from Nepal's devastating flash floods crossed 1,200 on Wednesday, as rescuers battled rain and debris to trace those believed to be trapped in the tunnels along the course of the Bhotekoshi river and underground powerhouses. Prime Minister Balendra Shah said the disaster's link to climate change must be strongly raised with the international community, as symbolic funerals were held by families of locals still missing after last week's flash floods.

According to Nepal's National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority, the death toll has reached 1,204 as more bodies were recovered from eight districts affected by the flood, while 4,216 people remain missing a week after the floods devastated towns and villages in the country's northern and central parts.

The security forces have recovered 348 dead bodies from Chitawan district, 217 from Nawalparasi East, 202 from Nawalparasi West, and 155 from Nuwakot. Similarly, 115 bodies were recovered from Rasuwa, 69 from Gorkha, 60 from Dhading and 38 from Tanahu.

Among the missing



Personnel clad in PPE suits carry the body of a flood victim on a stretcher as wrapped bodies lie on stretchers outside the Pashupatinath Electric Crematorium, in Kathmandu on Wednesday

PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Prime Minister Balendra Shah said the disaster's link to climate change must be strongly raised with the international community
- » The security forces have recovered 348 dead bodies from Chitawan district and 217 from Nawalparasi East

people, 583 are foreigners. The joint forces of security personnel including Nepal Army have so far rescued 11,993 people using helicopters and land route. Around 21,314 security personnel have been mobilised for the search and rescue operations.

The flash floods, triggered by an ice-rock avalanche near the Nepal-Tibet border on August 26, devastated towns and villages in northern and central Nepal, leaving a trail of destruction and thousands of people missing. According to Chinese

"According to experts, the flash flood in Bhotekoshi of Rasuwa district was caused by an ice-rock avalanche in the Himalayas. This incident shows the increasing risk the people of the mountain region have to bear with the occurrence of climate change," he said. "Therefore," Shah stressed, "We need to present the fact in a strong manner to the international community that the disaster is linked to climate change."

There is a global contribution behind climate change. And the responsibility to manage and minimise its effects also rests with the global community, the prime minister said.

officials, the death toll in the flash flood that struck Gyirong county in Tibet near the Nepal border has increased to 21, with 541 others still missing.

Nearly 100 Chinese nationals remain unaccounted for in Nepal, Chinese Foreign Ministry spokesperson Guo Jiakun told reporters in Beijing on Wednesday.

Addressing the House of Representatives, PM Shah said the scale and nature of the disaster raised serious questions about the growing risks faced by people living in the Himalayan region due to climate change.

Pak 'hopeful' for peace in West Asia despite recent escalation

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Islamabad, September 2

Pakistan on Wednesday said that it was "hopeful" for peace in West Asia despite recent escalation between the US and Iran, underlining the need for "dialogue and diplomacy" for stability in the region. The remark made by Foreign Office spokesperson Tahir Andrabi comes days after Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif met Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian on the sidelines of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) summit on Monday and discussed the evolving regional situation. "The prime minister

IN JUNE, THE US AND IRAN SIGNED AN MOU, AIMED AT BRINGING PEACE IN WEST ASIA

had reiterated Pakistan's commitment to peace through restraint, dialogue and diplomacy, while stressing that the Islamabad MoU offered the most viable pathway to lasting peace and stability in the region," Andrabi said. "Despite recent escalations, we remain hopeful, and we will continue to strive for dialogue and diplomacy," Andrabi said at a weekly press briefing.

SCO names Lahore as its 'Tourism and Cultural capital'

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Islamabad, September 2

Pakistan's cultural hub, Lahore, has been named the Tourism and Cultural Capital for 2026-27 by the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO).

The decision was announced at the 26th meeting of the SCO Council of Heads of State in Kyrgyzstan's capital, Bishkek, attended by

Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif. The Tourism and Cultural Capital title has been annually rotated among SCO member states since 2022 and aims to promote people-to-people contacts and tourism among member states while highlighting the cultural heritage of the country holding the organisation's rotating presidency, Dawn newspaper reported.

EXTENSION OF PERIODICITY OF SPECIAL TRAINS

This is notified for the information of passengers that Railways have decided to extend the periodicity of run of following Special Trains as per details given below:

Train No.	From	To	Days of Run	Notified up to	Period of Extension	No. of trips
02563	Barauni Jn.	New Delhi	Daily	31.08.26	04.09.26 to 30.11.26	88
02564	New Delhi	Barauni Jn.	Daily	01.09.26	05.09.26 to 01.12.26	88
02569	Darbhanga Jn.	New Delhi	Daily	31.08.26	04.09.26 to 30.11.26	88
02570	New Delhi	Darbhanga Jn.	Daily	01.09.26	05.09.26 to 01.12.26	88
09609	Udaipur City	Yog Nagari Rishikesh	Tuesday	28.07.26	20.10.26 to 24.11.26	06
09610	Yog Nagari Rishikesh	Udaipur City	Wednesday	29.07.26	21.10.26 to 25.11.26	06

Note :- Rest of the instructions will hold good.

For any kind of information such as detailed Time-Table of other stations enroute and composition etc., passengers are requested to contact RailMadad Helpline No. 139 or visit Indian Railways website <https://enquiry.indianrail.gov.in> or NTES App.

RailMadad Helpline No. 139

Visit RailMadad Website:- www.railmadad.indianrailways.gov.in
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झारखण्ड सरकार
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय,
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, रामगढ़
ई० सामान्य निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

ई-निविदा सं० : RDSD/RAMGARH/24/2026-27

1. कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी :- MMGSY मद अन्तर्गत।

क्र	आई०-टी/फिकेशन संख्या / पैकेज संख्या	प्रखण्ड	योजना का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि	अग्रघन की राशि (रु०)	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य (रु०)	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
1	RDSD/RGH/24/2026-27	दुलमी	रामगढ़ जिला के प्रखण्ड दुलमी अंतर्गत ग्राम-भंवायत- सिरु से पोना के मध्य कोची नदी पर पुल निर्माण।	33651000	674000	10000	18 (अठारह माह)

2. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि :- दिनांक 08.09.2026

3. ई-निविदा प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय :- दिनांक 08.09.2026 से 07.10.2026 को अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक।

4. ई-निविदा खोलने का स्थान :- कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, रामगढ़।

5. ई-निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :- 09.10.2026 अपराह्न 02:00 बजे।

6. ई-निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता :- कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, रामगढ़।

7. ई निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष सं० :- 7488152930

8. परिमाण विपत्र की राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है। तदनुसार अग्रघन की राशि देय होगी।

9. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि केवल Online Mode द्वारा स्वीकार्य होगी।

10. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि का ई-मुग्तान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रघन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर खाता को बन्द कर दिया जाता है तो उसकी सारी जवाबदेही संबंधित संवेदक की होगी।

विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए वेबसाइट Jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं कार्यालय की सूचना पट्ट पर देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता,
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, रामगढ़।

PR 388868 (Rural Work Department) 26-27 (D)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Arif S/o Sabbir Hasan**, R/o A-8, Gali No. 2, Kachhi Colony, Kardam Puri, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case **FIR No. 68/2019 U/S 392/394/411/34 IPC at P.S. Shastri Park, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Arif** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Arif** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s **84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Arif** accused of **FIR No. 68/2019 U/S 392/394/411/34 IPC at P.S. Shastri Park, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.12.2026**.

By Order: Ms. Norma Jain,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03,
Room No. 22, First Floor, North-East Distt.,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi.

DP/12306/NE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Mr. Shyam Parashar** Proprietor M/s. Ass Pee Telecom System R/o H. No. 211A, Block E3, 25 Foot Road Moladband Extn., Badapur, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence CT Case No. 2189/19 u/s 138 N.I. Act at P.S. Mayur Vihar, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Mr. Shyam Parashar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Mr. Shyam Parashar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr. P.C. has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Mr. Shyam Parashar** accused of CT Case No. 2189/19 u/s 138 N.I. Act at P.S. Mayur Vihar, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.12.2026**.

By Order: Ms. Ritika Kansal,
Judicial Magistrate First Class, (Mahila Court-02), East
Room No. 24,
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/12170/ED/2026

MADHYA PRADESH POWER GENERATING COMPANY LIMITED
OFFICE OF THE ADDL. CHIEF ENGINEER (THC), SIRMOUR, REWA (M.P.)

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (Through e-tendering Process Only)

M.P. Power Generating Co. Ltd. invites e-tenders from reputed/established Contractor/Firm/Service Provider/Joint Venture for the following items: -

Tender No.	Tender Particulars	Estimated Cost in Rs. (inclusive of Taxes)/ Tender Cost in Rs./ Period	EMD in Rs.	Date and Time for Closing of Online Submission	Date & time of e-opening of Tender
2026_MPPGC_502612_1	Work contract for construction of five no. of septic tank in place of existing damaged septic tank for A, B, C, D, E & F type quarters of MPPGCL colony Silpara	12.39 Lakh/ 1000/- Period 3 Months	24,800/-	05.10.2026 Up to 15:00 hrs.	07.10.2026 from 15:00 hrs. onwards
2026_MPPGC_520310_1	Work contract for construction of boundary wall with RCC frame and concertina gencing on top of wall near power house-I, 3x105 MW, THP, MPPGCL, Sirmour	208.39 Lakh/ 5000/- Period 18 Months	2,08,400/-	05.10.2026 Up to 15:00 hrs.	07.10.2026 from 15:00 hrs. onwards

For further details of amendments/extensions/corrigendums etc. please visit website <https://mptenders.gov.in> in regularly. No separate information shall be published in print media for instant tender.

M.P. Madhyam/127855/2026

// SAVE ELECTRICITY //

ADDL. CHIEF ENGINEER (THC),

News at a glance

Rupee rises 22 paise to close at 94.73 against US dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee settled at 94.73 on Wednesday, recording a gain of 22 paise on the back of robust foreign capital inflows, notwithstanding weak domestic stock markets and higher crude oil prices. Forex traders said the RBI is keeping a tab on the rupee's fall as Brent crude prices have risen to USD 95 per barrel and the dollar index is hovering around 99.80 on a bout of risk aversion on renewed US-Iran tensions. Investor sentiment also impacted after the 10-year US Treasury yields rose above 4.8 per cent - the highest since January 2025.

India soon to be 3rd largest wind energy player: Official

NEW DELHI: India will soon surpass Germany to become the third-largest wind energy producer in the World, as the nation is poised to achieve 107 GW capacity by 2030, Joint Secretary in the Ministry of New & Renewable Energy Rajesh Kulhari-said on Wednesday. Speaking at the curtain raiser of the 8th Windenergy India, he said: "We have surpassed Brazil this year. We are at 58 GW while Germany is currently at 77 GW, we are on track to surpass Germany before 2030 with more than 107 GW (wind capacity)."

Strictly follow food safety norms: FSSAI to 5-star hotels

NEW DELHI: Sending out a strong message after multiple violations by hotels, watchdog FSSAI has asked all leading 5-star hospitality firms in the country to strictly follow food safety norms and ensure hygiene benchmarks. FSSAI CEO Rajit Punhani, in a meeting with senior executives of major hotel companies held on Tuesday, asserted that it has "zero tolerance" for any violations, according to sources. The direction to hospitality companies comes in the wake of the FSSAI's recent notices to two major 5-star hotels in Delhi.

Bengaluru: 16th Aero India to be held from February 8-12

NEW DELHI: India's biennial aerospace exhibition Aero India will be held at Yelahanka on the outskirts of Bengaluru from February 8-12 with an aim to project the country as a hub for defence manufacturing. Aero India has emerged as a flagship international event showcasing the nation's growing capabilities in aerospace, defence manufacturing and emerging technologies. It brings together leading global aerospace and defence companies, policymakers, technology experts and defence forces personnel on a common platform.

UNDER INDIA'S CHAIRSHIP

Innovation & digital cooperation to take centre stage at BRICS Summit

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 2

India is set to put innovation, digital cooperation and inclusive technology at the centre of its BRICS agenda as it prepares to host the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi on September 12-13.

With the leaders' summit approaching, India has used its BRICS Chairship to push cooperation in emerging technologies, artificial intelligence, digital public infrastructure, startups, scientific research and women's participation in technology and entrepreneurship.

The summit will be held under the theme "Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability", which is rooted in Prime Minister Narendra Modi's vision of "Humanity First".

This will be India's fourth time hosting the BRICS Summit, after it hosted the leaders' meetings in 2012, 2016 and 2021.

As part of its Chairship, India has highlighted its



digital public infrastructure (DPI) ecosystem, including Aadhaar and the Unified Payments Interface (UPI), as examples of affordable, scalable and inclusive digital solutions.

The focus on technology has also featured in a series of ministerial and working-group meetings held during the year. The 12th BRICS Communications Ministers' Meeting, hosted by India in August, discussed artificial intelligence, cloud technologies, digital governance and resilient communication networks.

India has also sought to strengthen innovation and entrepreneurship cooperation among BRICS

countries through initiatives such as the proposed BRICS Startup Innovation Fund and BRICS Startup Innovation Network.

These initiatives are aimed at creating greater opportunities for startups, investors and innovation ecosystems across member countries.

Another proposal, the BRICS Science and Research Repository, seeks to facilitate the sharing of research capabilities and strengthen scientific cooperation among BRICS nations.

The Chairship has also given greater attention to women's participation in technology and entrepreneurship.

INSIGHT

» India prepares to host the 18th BRICS Summit in Delhi on Sept 12-13

» The summit will be held under the theme 'Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability'

barriers that limit women's participation and leadership in STEM and entrepreneurship.

The upcoming summit is expected to provide an opportunity for BRICS leaders to discuss a common approach towards innovation in the artificial intelligence era, digital cooperation, scientific collaboration and inclusive growth.

The deliberations will take place against the backdrop of rapid technological change and evolving global challenges, with member countries expected to explore ways to leverage technology and innovation to build resilient, sustainable and inclusive economies.

Through its Chairship, India has sought to position BRICS as not only a platform for economic and geopolitical cooperation, but also as a forum for practical partnerships in emerging technologies, digital public infrastructure, startups, scientific research and inclusive innovation.

The BRICS Women Working Group has been working towards policy cooperation on digital inclusion and women's entrepreneurship.

The BRICS Women's Startup Contest, organised through the BRICS Women's Business Alliance, is aimed at identifying and supporting women-led ventures in sectors such as sustainability, innovation and technology.

The Women in Innovation, Science and Entrepreneurship (WISE) initiative is focused on three areas -- innovation and collaboration, access to funding and policy advocacy. It seeks to address gender gaps and structural

Sitharaman holds series of meetings on sidelines of G20
Talks focus on strengthening economic ties

Washington, September 2

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman held a series of high-level meetings with her counterparts from Russia and South Korea, European Union officials, and the heads of the IMF and World Bank on the sidelines of the G20 Finance Ministers and Central Bank Governors (FMCBG) meeting in Asheville, focusing on strengthening economic partnerships and addressing global financial challenges.

Sitharaman met Russian Finance Minister Anton Siluanov and discussed ways to deepen bilateral cooperation, as well as collaboration through multilateral development institutions.

They discussed cooperation in the New Development Bank and the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank and explored measures to strengthen their effectiveness. They also discussed the proposed establishment of a Shanghai Cooperation Organisation Development Bank.

In her meeting with European Commissioner for Economy Valdis Dombrovskis, Sitharaman discussed deepening the



Nirmala Sitharaman during a meeting with IMF Managing Director Kristalina Georgieva

PTI

India-EU Economic and Financial Partnership, including through the macroeconomic dialogue and Trade and Technology Council. They reviewed ongoing negotiations for an India-EU free trade agreement and Investment Protection Agreement.

Sitharaman also met South Korean Deputy Prime Minister Koo Yun-keol to discuss bilateral financial cooperation, critical minerals, investment flows and resilient supply chains. The two sides also discussed advancing QR-based payment interoperability and proposed infrastructure financing under Korea's EDCF framework.

With IMF Managing Director Kristalina Georgieva, Sitharaman discussed the global economic outlook and India's growth trajectory. She highlighted India's strong macroeconomic fundamentals and called for economic assessments to appropriately reflect structural changes in emerging economies.

Sitharaman also met World Bank President Ajay Banga and discussed expanding cooperation in infrastructure and bond markets.

They explored greater use of MIGA guarantees to mobilise private capital and deepen corporate, infrastructure and municipal bond markets. AGENCIES

Licenses of 50 pharma firms in Guj 'cancelled'

MPOST BUREAU
Gandhinagar, September 2

The Gujarat Food and Drug Control Administration (FDCA) has cancelled the licenses of 50 pharmaceutical firms and issued closure orders to two units, Health Minister Praful Pansheriya said on Wednesday.

The state has a zero tolerance policy towards counterfeit and illegal medicines, he said at a review meeting of the FDCA here. The FDCA's work during August was reviewed at the meeting chaired by Pansheriya.

The minister instructed officials to adopt a zero tolerance policy against elements that compromise citizens' health by selling counterfeit and illegal medicines.

Following intensive investigations conducted by the FDCA, sale licenses of 50 drug firms were cancelled, closure orders were issued to two drug manufacturing companies, licenses of eight manufacturing companies were suspended and manufacturing licenses of 11 drugs were also cancelled in the last few months, the minister said. In addition, a special drive was organized to check the quality of antibiotic medicines sold in rural areas, in which 588 samples were collected, Pansheriya said.

Goyal hits back at Oppn, Garg over remarks on Q1 GDP growth

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 2

Commerce minister Piyush Goyal on Wednesday criticised Opposition parties and former finance secretary Subhash Garg over his remarks on the 7.8 per cent GDP growth, saying he did not know how to 'compare apples with apples' and was trying to misguide the people of India.

Goyal said that in this global world of turmoil, India is an oasis in the desert and the country continued to be the fastest-growing amongst large economies of the world.

"The naysayers can say what they want, but 7.8 per cent growth is a reality.

'THE NAYSAYERS CAN SAY WHAT THEY WANT, BUT 7.8% GROWTH IS A REALITY,' HE SAID

When I see on television some of the opposition leaders, even possibly you can throw in along with them a former finance secretary or a former Reserve Bank governor, both of whom could not complete their time in India or in the government and for the right reasons. They don't even know how to compare apples with apples. They are trying to misguide the people of India, comparing a growth rate

at an old series with a new series, where the base year itself has changed," Goyal told reporters here.

He added that critics were trying to find shortcomings in the growth figures by asking, "Okay, there is 7.8 per cent growth, but where are the jobs?" He said the demand for workers was strong, particularly in the textile sector, citing requests from industry in Tiruppur for more workers. "Send me 100,000 people in Tiruppur, we will fill and provide them a job," he said.

He said that the naysayers somehow are not able to digest that they themselves are the "only jobless people left".

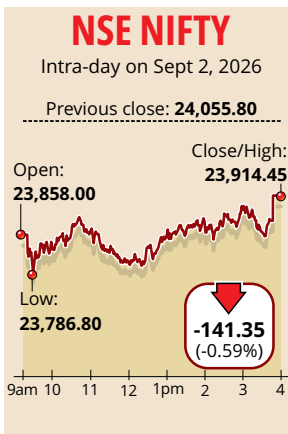
Mkts fall for 3rd day amid higher oil prices

MPOST BUREAU
Mumbai, September 2

Stock markets declined for the third consecutive day on Wednesday, with the benchmark Sensex closing nearly 374 points lower amid a bearish trend in global equities and higher oil prices due to escalating conflict in West Asia.

The 30-share BSE Sensex dropped 373.93 points, or 0.49 per cent, to settle at 76,570.35, dragged by selling in auto, IT, and banking shares. During the day, it tumbled 808.56 points, or 1.05 per cent, to 76,135.72.

The 50-share NSE Nifty slumped 141.35 points, or 0.59 per cent, to end at 23,914.45. The index moved between a high



of 23,914.45 and a low of 23,786.80 during the day.

Among the 30 Sensex firms, Asian Paints, HDFC Bank, Mahindra & Mahindra, HCL Tech, Bharat Electronics and Infosys were the major laggards.

Adani Ports, Bajaj Finserv, Power Grid, NTPC



and Titan were among the winners.

Broader markets also declined as the BSE Small-Cap Select index dropped 0.61 per cent and the Mid-Cap Select index dipped 0.51 per cent.

Among BSE sectoral indices, Auto dropped the

most by 1.68 per cent and IT tanked 1.17 per cent. Focused IT (1.10 per cent), Insurance (1.09 per cent), Capital Goods (1.08 per cent), Consumer Discretionary (0.86 per cent) and Consumer Discretionary (0.86 per cent) also closed lower.

Energy, Utilities, Power, Realty, Services, Housing Finance and PSU Bank were the winners.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, climbed 0.40 per cent to USD 95.13 per barrel.

In Asian markets, South Korea's Kospi tumbled 3.99 per cent, and Japan's Nikkei 225 index dropped 2.85 per cent. Shanghai's SSE Composite index and Hong Kong's Hang Seng index also ended lower.

Steps to boost aircraft leasing activities reviewed
Civil Aviation Min chairs 1st meeting of panel on aircraft leasing & financing

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 2

A high-level committee, chaired by Civil Aviation Minister K Ram Mohan Naidu, on Wednesday discussed measures to boost aircraft leasing and financing activities in the country, including issues related to taxation and availability of finance.

The first meeting of the panel on aircraft leasing and financing was attended by senior officials from the civil aviation and finance min-

KEY POINTS

» It took up a range of issues to create an enabling environment for aircraft leasing

» The availability of aircraft remains a key bottleneck, Naidu said

istries, Department of Commerce, Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA), Reserve Bank of India (RBI), IFSCA and representatives of indus-

try associations.

"The committee also took up a range of issues to create an enabling environment for aircraft leasing and financing, including taxation, regulatory frameworks, availability of finance and ease of doing business. Discussions included the potential for rupee-denominated financing for aircraft, greater clarity on the applicability of GAAR (General Anti-Avoidance Rule), and the possibility of renegotiating the Double Taxation

Avoidance Agreement framework with Ireland."

At the meeting, Naidu suggested the need for exploring mechanisms for greater allocation of bank credit to the aircraft sector and identifying joint ventures for technical and skill development in the aircraft leasing segment.

The government's efforts to encourage aircraft leasing and boost lessor confidence are yielding results, with 422 assets, including 250 aircraft and 87 engines, having been leased through

the International Financial Services Centre (IFSC) and 474 leasing agreements having been signed, the release said. International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA) is the regulator for IFSC.

The minister said the availability of aircraft remains a key bottleneck and emphasised the need for a coordinated and time-bound approach towards addressing the identified regulatory, financing and taxation-related issues.

JCR upgrades India's sovereign rating to A-

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 2

Banking on "solid" economic growth and a strong financial system, Japanese credit rating agency JCR on Wednesday upgraded India's sovereign rating to 'A-', a feat achieved after a gap of 35 years. JCR's 'A' rating implies a high level of certainty to honour its financial obligations.

The rating upgrade from 'BBB+' to 'A-' comes within days of India's NSO publishing higher-than-expected GDP data, which showed the econ-

omy grew 7.8 per cent in the first quarter on strong performance by the manufacturing and services sector, despite global headwinds.

"Considering India's solid economic growth, the effectiveness of economic policies that strengthen the foundations for growth, and the improved soundness of the financial system, JCR has upgraded the Republic of India's Foreign Currency and Local Currency Long-term Issuer Ratings by one notch to 'A-'," it said.

Gill, Bumrah slip in ICC Test rankings

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Dubai, September 2

Captain Shubman Gill slipped two positions among batters and Jasprit Bumrah dropped one spot down among bowlers, while Devdutt Padikkal rose up to the 54th spot among Indians in the latest ICC Test rankings released on Wednesday.

Gill, who returned with only one half-century across three innings on the Sri Lanka tour, slipped two positions to reach ninth as wicketkeeper-batter Rishabh Pant remains the highest ranked Indian batter in Test cricket at seventh.

There was no change in position for Yashasvi Jaiswal.

Padikkal, who was India's best batter on the tour of the Island nation with 328 runs across two Tests with two centuries, moved up five places up to reach the 54th position.

KEY BCCI STAKEHOLDERS TO MEET TODAY

Agarkar, Gambhir set to press COE on return-to-play deadlines for injured stars

The June-July debacle in the UK is expected to be discussed at length

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 2

Injury management of key players heading into a crucial all-format tour of New Zealand and the broader roadmap for next year's ODI World Cup will be the key points of discussion at a BCCI review meeting featuring head coach Gautam Gambhir and chairman of selectors Ajit Agarkar in Mumbai on Thursday.

The June-July debacle in the UK is expected to be discussed at length but it is also understood that stakeholders, including BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia, want to look ahead.

Centre of Excellence head VVS Laxman is also expected to join the meeting. The tour of New Zealand is scheduled in October-November.

Those tracking the latest developments in Indian cricket say Agarkar and Gambhir could have some very specific queries on



Agarkar's current contract ends on October 4

the injured centrally-contracted and targeted players who are undergoing rehabilitation at the Bengaluru-based COE.

"The selection committee chief was informally intimidated before the Sri Lanka Tests that Jasprit Bumrah would be

fit for at least one if not two Tests. In fact, he had written a mail to COE seeking more clarity on Bumrah's absence.

KEY POINTS

- » The tour of New Zealand is scheduled in October-November
- » Centre of Excellence head VVS Laxman is also expected to join the meeting

"His (Bumrah) absence was felt in the second Test where Siraj looked distinctly off-colour on a placid track. Ditto for Hardik Pandya, who hasn't played anything post IPL and is important as far as the ODI World Cup is concerned," a BCCI source told PTI on conditions of anonymity.

While it is very difficult to set a specific date for any player's return as bodies are different and so are the types of injuries but at times, the COE's Sports Science team has often failed to provide even an approximate time-line.

Lakshya makes another early exit

Srikanth, Tanvi progress in China Masters; SatChi too advance



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Shenzhen, September 2

Lakshya Sen was knocked out of the China Masters after a listless performance in the opening round but Kidambi Srikanth and Tanvi Sharma registered straight-game wins to progress to the second round of men's and women's singles competition here on Wednesday.

Lakshya, a 2021 world championships bronze-medallist, played an error-riddled game to go down 14-21 7-21 in 38 minutes to world No. 9 Canada's Victor Lai, who won his second bronze medal at the World Championships last month.

It was Lakshya's third defeat to the Canadian with his only win being at the All England Championships in March this year.

Srikanth, a 2021 world championships silver-medallist, however, progressed after beating Chinese Taipei's Chi Yu Jen 21-16 21-15 in another men's singles opener.

The former World No. 1 Indian, who reached the US Open final this year, will face Lai next.

Tanvi, who won her maiden BWF World Tour title at the Taipei Open last month, defeated Denmark's Amalie Schulz 21-16 21-17 to also advance to the women's singles second round.

The 17-year-old from Punjab, a bronze medallist at the Junior World Championships in Guwahati last year, will face Japan's Tomoka Miyazaki next.

The Asian Games gold medallist pair will next take on the Popov brothers -- Christo and Toma Junior -- of France.

Tilak Varma guides South Zone to Duleep Trophy final

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Bengaluru, September 2

Skipper Tilak Varma played a second successive influential knock, guiding South Zone to the Duleep Trophy final with a seven-wicket win over North Zone on the fourth and final day of the semifinal here on Wednesday.

Chasing 181, South Zone got the job done in the first two sessions of the day after Tilak (51 not out) and Ravichandran Smaran (32 not out) milked 80 runs for the unbroken fourth wicket stand.

South ended with 182 for three towards the end of the second session and they will face East Zone in the title clash in Chennai from September 6.

Tilak, who had made an unbeaten 116 in the first innings to help South gain a match-clinching 117-run lead, came to the



middle when his side was wobbling at 102 for three. But the left-hander, who is also India's vice-

SOUTH ENDED WITH 182 FOR THREE TOWARDS THE END OF THE SECOND SESSION AND THEY WILL FACE EAST ZONE IN THE TITLE CLASH IN CHENNAI FROM SEPTEMBER 6

captain for the upcoming T20I series against Afghanistan, once again displayed temperament and technique to counter North bowlers led by fiery pacer Gurnoor Brar and the wily left-arm spinner Abid Mushtaq.

Brar tested his resolve with a series of rib-crackers while Mushtaq exploited the variable bounce on the pitch to challenge Tilak's footwork.

He aced those challenges in spectacular fashion, essaying some sumptuous drives on the off-side. Once he settled down, Tilak played a reverse sweep and paddle sweep off Mushtaq to take South

closer to the target.

Smaran, at the other end, was an able ally, rotating the strike with efficiency and occasionally freed his hands.

The young left-hander's cracking off-drive off Nishant Sindhu was a sight for sore eyes.

Both southpaws' confidence knocks meant that South also overcame early dismissals of Narayan Jagadeesan (43) and Ricky Bhui (42), who added 64 runs for the opening wicket and Shaik Rashseed.

Jagadeesan, who was dropped in 14 by stumper Kanaiah Wadhawan off Brar, had some heated engagements with the

strapping fast bowler.

Eventually, Tilak, who batted on all four days of the match, fittingly, brought the winning runs eventually when he creamed part-time leg-spinner Qamran Iqbal for a boundary through the covers.

However, North had their own little moments once they resumed their second innings from 256 for seven for an overall lead of 139 runs.

Anshul Kamboj's 29-ball 36 helped them stretch that lead over a healthy 180.

The chase indeed seemed getting trickier on a crumbling pitch once South lost three wickets early. But North's sloppy fielding too played a big role in letting South off the hook.

But they found two willing generals in Tilak and Smaran to romp home.

e - Tender Notice
Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana, Maharashtra Rural Road Development Association, Dharashiv
e - Tender Notice No. 05/2026-27

The Superintending Engineer, PMGSY, MRDA, Chh. Sambhajinagar Region, Chh. Sambhajinagar invites the bids in electronic tendering system published on <https://www.pmgstenders.gov.in> for construction of roads Under Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana Sanctioned Total Packages - 01 (Total Road works - 02) in Dharashiv District.

Date of Sale & Submission starts from 03/09/2026 at 11.00 am respectively. Ends on 17/09/2026 at 17.00 pm.

Further notification & Clarification will be published on website.

(Sd/-) (Sd/-)
Executive Engineer (PMGSY), Dgipr2026-27/2607 Superintending Engineer (PMGSY), MRDA, Chh. Sambhajinagar

HIMACHAL PRADESH JAL SHAKTI VIBHAG
E-PROCUREMENT NOTICE
*** NOTICE FOR BIDS (IFB)***

The Executive Engineer Jal Shakti Division Jawalamukhi District Kangra (HP) on behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh invited the item rate/lump sum contract bids from the eligible contractors/Firms. Bidders should be registered with Jal Shakti Vibhag Himachal Pradesh. The scope of the work will be as under:-

Sr. No.	Name of work.	Estimated Cost.	EMD	Cost of Tender form	Time limit
1	Improvement and Augmentation of US Bhardoli Phase-2nd in Tehsil Jawalamukhi District Kangra (H.P.) (SH- C/O Intake, C/O Collection Tank, C/O Pump House cum attendant Room, S/E Pumping Machinery, P/L Rising Main, Laying of Distribution Network, C/O Outlet Chamber).	3,34,27,577/-	409276/-	7000/-	One Year

Last date of filling/ uploading the tender through e-tendering:- **09.09.2026 upto 11.00 A.M.**
The tender form and other detailed conditions can be obtained from the website www.jsvhp.org

Executive Engineer,
Jal Shakti Division Jawalamukhi.

Ro.No 3116/2026-2027

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is for general information that I Aarri Kumari VV/o Ranjit Kumar Shah R/o A-50/370B, Ganesh Nagar Extn, Shakarpur, East Delhi, Delhi-92, declare that name of mine and my husband have been wrongly written as Arti Devi and Ranjeet Kumar in my minor daughter namely **TANVI** aged 14 years in her educational documents. The actual name of mine and my husband are Aarri Kumari And Ranjit Kumar Shah respectively, which may be amended accordingly.

DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL-II, CHENNAI
6th Floor, Additional Office Building, Shastri Bhavan, Haddows Road, Nungambakkam, Chennai - 600 006
O.A. No.22 of 2026

Indian Bank, Stressed Asset Management Branch Chennai (IFSC : IDIB00A0113) No.55, 2nd Floor, Ethiraj Salai, Egmore, Chennai - 600 008, Rep. by its Chief Manager ...Applicant

Vs-
(1) **Mr. V. Bhaskar**, S/o Venkatraman (PAN : AGDPB8437F), No.B-138, 1st Floor, Chittranjan Park, Kalkaji, South Delhi, New Delhi - 110019.
(2) **Mr. V. Nandhakumar**, S/o Venkatraman (PAN : AAEPN9253E), #1510, 15th Floor, 7th Block, Silver Oak Alliance Orchid Springs, No.54, Water Canal Road, Korattur, Chennai - 600 076. ...Defendants

SUMMONS TO DEFENDANT THOROUGH SUBSTITUTED SERVICE

Whereas the Applicant has instituted the above application u/s 19 of the Recovery of Debts and Bankruptcy Act, 1993 against Defendant for the recovery of a sum mentioned therein together with current and future interest and other reliefs. The service of summons/notice to the 1st Defendant could not be effected in the ordinary manner and hence substituted service has been ordered by this Tribunal and hence this notice through paper publication.

The Hon'ble Tribunal has ordered notice through paper publication to you returnable on 28.09.2026 at 11.00 A.M. before Debt Recovery Tribunal-II, at 6th Floor, Additional Office Building, Shastri Bhavan, Haddows Road, Nungambakkam, Chennai - 600 006, Tamil Nadu for your appearance.

The 1st Defendant is hereby required to appear on the date and time mentioned above either in person or by a Legal Practitioner or duly authorized agent duly instructed as to why the relief prayed for should not be granted. Take notice that in case of default, the application will be heard and determined in your absence.

M/s. Anand, Samy & Dhruva
Counsel for the Applicant

ICICI Home Finance
Corporate Office: ICICI Home Finance Company Limited ICICI HFC Tower, Andheri - Kurla Road, Andheri (East), Mumbai- 400059, India
Branch Office: 308A, 308B, 327A & 327B, 3rd Floor, DGE Block, Plot No.11, Golden-1, Greater Noida West, U.P.-201301
[See proviso to rule 8(6)] Notice for sale of immovable assets

E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8 (6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged/charged to the Secured Creditor, the Possession of which has been taken by the Authorized Officer of ICICI Home Finance Company Ltd., will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is", and "Whatever there is", as per the brief particulars given hereunder;

Sr. No.	Name of Borrower(s)/ Co Borrowers/ Guarantors/ Legal Heirs. Loan Account No.	Details of the Secured asset(s) with known encumbrances, if any	Amount Outstanding	Reserve Price Earnest Money Deposit	Date and Time of Property Inspection	Date & Time of Auction	One Day Before Auction Date	SARFAESI Stage
(A)	(B)	(C)	(D)	(E)	(F)	(G)	(H)	(I)
1.	Amit Khurana (Borrower) Jyoti Arora (Co-Borrower) Loan No. NHNOD00000736765	Flat No. 0104, Floor 2nd, Block- F, Colony Known As "Anthea Floors" Situated At Wildflower Country, Sector-70, Gurgaon-122103	Rs. 2,66.84, 692/- August 31, 2026	Rs. 2,25,03, 339/- August 31, 2026	September 28, 2026 11:00 AM To 03:00 PM	October 05, 2026 02:00 PM To 03:00 PM	October 03, 2026 Before 05:00 PM	Symbolic Possession

The online auction will be conducted on website (URL Link- <https://BidDeal.in>) of our auction agency ValueTrust Capital Services Private Limited. The Mortgagees/ notice are given a last chance to pay the total dues with further interest till October 03, 2026 before 05:00 PM else these secured assets will be sold as per above schedule.

The Prospective Bidder(s) must submit the Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) RTGS/ Demand Draft (DD) (Refer Column E) at ICICI Home Finance Company Limited Branch Office Address mentioned on top of the article on or before October 03, 2026 before 04:00 PM. The Prospective Bidder(s) must also submit signed copy of Registration Form & Bid Terms and Conditions form at ICICI Home Finance Company Limited Branch Office Address mentioned on top of the article on or before October 03, 2026 before 05:00 PM. Earnest Money Deposit Demand Draft (DD) should be from a Nationalized/Scheduled Bank in favor of "ICICI Home Finance Company Ltd. - Auction" payable at the branch office address mentioned on top of the article.

For any further clarifications with regards to inspection, terms and conditions of the auction or submission of tenders, kindly contact ICICI Home Finance Company Limited on 9920807300 or Value Trust Centralised Help Desk No. 6200-22-6200.

The Authorized Officer reserves the right to reject any or all the bids without furnishing any further reasons. For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please visit <https://www.icicifhc.com>.

Date: September 03, 2026 Authorized Officer, "ICICI Home Finance Company Limited", Place: Gurgaon CIN Number:- U65922MH1999PLC120106

कार्यालय, आदित्यपुर नगर निगम (अभियंत्रण शाखा)
कल्पनपुरी, आदित्यपुर इन्डस्ट्रीयल एरिया, आदित्यपुर
e-mail : mcadityapur2@gmail.com

अल्पकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या- **UDD/AMC/03/2026-27** दिनांक- 02.09.2026

युप सं	वार्ड सं	कार्य का नाम	निविदा की राशि	अग्रघन की राशि	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1		Construction of Twelve (12) Unit of Community Toilet/Public Toilet/Aspirational toilet (9 seater) in different locations under Adityapur Municipal Corporation	3,37,46,773.00	6,75,00.00	25000.00	15 माह
2		Construction of Thirteen (13) Unit of Community Toilet/Public Toilet/Aspirational toilet (9 seater) in different locations under Adityapur Municipal Corporation	3,65,59,004.00	7,31,500.00	25000.00	15 माह
3		Construction of Four (04) Unit of Community Toilet/Public Toilet/Aspirational toilet (5 seater) in different locations under Adityapur Municipal Corporation	80,15,967.22	1,60,500.00	10000.00	12 माह
2		वेबसाइट पर निविदा अपलोड करने की तिथि	दिनांक- 10.09.2026 (अपराह्न 5.00 बजे से)			
3		निविदा प्राप्त करने की अंतिम तिथि	दिनांक- 21.09.2026 (अपराह्न 5.00 बजे तक)			
4		निविदा खोलने की तिथि	दिनांक- 23.09.2026 (अपराह्न 4.00 बजे)			
5		निविदा आमंत्रण करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम	नगर आयुक्त, नगर निगम आदित्यपुर			
6		निविदा से संबंधित जानकारी हेतु मोबाइल नम्बर	8709782566			
7		ई-प्रोक्यूरमेंट सेल का हेल्पलाइन नम्बर	8709782566			

• Only e-tenders are acceptable. Further details can be seen on website <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>
• पथ निर्माण विभाग, झारखण्ड सरकार, राँची के संकल्प सं 2146 दिनांक 09.09.2020 में निहित प्रावधानों से यह निविदा प्रक्रिया अचछादित होगी।
नगर आयुक्त
नगर निगम, आदित्यपुर

PR 388922 Urban Development (26-27)_D

CHHATTISGARH STATE POWER TRANS. CO. LTD.
(A Govt. of Chhattisgarh undertaking) (A successor company of CSEB) CIN: U40108CT2003SGCO15820
O/o CHIEF ENGINEER (STORE & PURCHASE)
3rd Floor, SLDC Building, Daganija Raipur-492013 GSTIN-22AADCC5773E1ZX
No.02-16/SE(S&P)/TR-25/S&P/61/53/54/ 1/611676/2026 Raipur, Dtd:01-09-2026

E - BIDDING TENDER NOTICE

Online bids are invited by the undersigned through CSPTCL e-bidding system (SAP SRM) from experienced manufacturers/eligible bidders for Supply/repairing of following material-

S. N.	Tender no. /RFx No.	Description	Due Date & time
1	TR-25/S&P/61 RFx No-8100054044	220 KV C&R Panel For Feeder, Transformer, Busbar Protection & Spare relays	29.09.2026 Upto 15:00 Hrs
2	TR-25/S&P/53 RFx No-8100054045	Repairing of 1 No. 40MVA, 132/33 KV Power Transformer (ALSTOM make) failed at 132 KV S/s Silpahari	30.09.2026 Upto 15:00Hrs
3	TR-25/S&P/54 RFx No-8100054046	Repairing of 1 No. 40MVA, 132/33 KV Power Transformer (EMCO make) failed at 132 KV S/s Simga	01.10.2026 Upto 15:00Hrs

The details of NIT can be viewed from our website www.cspc.co.in and the Tender Documents can be viewed and downloaded online from our e-bidding portal:- <https://ebidding.cspc.co.in:50724/irj/portal> Any amendment/corrigendum, if required, will be displayed on our website only.

CHIEF ENGINEER (S&P)
SAVE ELECTRICITY samvad 48921/1 **CSPTCL: RAIPUR**

'WANT FILMS LIKE THIS IN MY FILMOGRAPHY'

Taapsee revealed she prioritises filmography over 100-crore films even after 20 years

Taapsee Pannu opened up about the pressure surrounding box-office numbers and commercial success in Bollywood. The actress said she is comfortable not having several Rs 100-crore films to her credit. She believes the long-term value of her work matters more than immediate box-office results. In a conversation with IANS, Pannu explained why she prioritises her filmography when making career decisions. For Taapsee, a film's box-office performance doesn't necessarily determine its lasting impact. She pointed out that several well-regarded movies have taken years to receive their due recognition. "There are a lot of good films that don't run at the box office. Then after 10 years, we will bring them to the best films of the decades. Then we give them cult status. Then they are worshipped. Then

their reference points are made. I mean, I have seen a lot like this in my career," she said. She said this perspective has influenced the projects she accepts. She has consciously chosen the quality of her body of work instead of pursuing short-term commercial rewards.

"So, it's a conscious choice that I have made of choosing my filmography over temporary reward. Because this filmography is going to stay; time will change. Today, there are films like this. Tomorrow, there will be films like that. Earlier, there were other

kinds of films. But my filmography won't change. It will stay the same," she said.

Pannu said she wants to look back at her work years later and still feel that she made the right choice. She considers that kind of satisfaction more important than an immediate box-office achievement. "So, I want films like this in my filmography. Even after 20 years, if I watch it, I will feel that yes, this was a good film," she said.

However, she acknowledged that taking this approach can come with criticism. Actors can be judged harshly when their films do not deliver commercially, even if those projects

eventually find an audience. "Obviously, you have to pay the reward for this. You are told that your filmography is a flop. And then you have to wait for 10 years for it to get cult status. Then you can give big interviews. In the same year, no one is asking about the other hit films that have been made. So, it's such a weird cycle. As an actor, you go through it," she said.

AGENCIES

FOR HER, A FILM'S BOX-OFFICE PERFORMANCE DOESN'T NECESSARILY DETERMINE ITS LASTING IMPACT



Rukmini Maitra to star opposite Akshay Kumar in 'Samuk'?

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, September 2

Bollywood star Akshay Kumar is presently shooting for Vipul Amrutlal Shah's sci-fi action thriller 'Samuk' in the UK. And reportedly, Bengali actress Rukmini Maitra might be seen as the lead actress opposite Khiladi Kumar. Directed by Kanishk Varma, the film is expected to be released in 2027.

If Rukmini finally gets cast as the leading lady, then this would be a breakthrough for the Bengali actress. Mostly South Indian actresses are seen alongside major Bollywood actors, but if Rukmini lands the role, this would indeed be a huge achievement for a Bengali actress. Despite working



THE FILM IS BEING SHOT IN THE UK

in Bengali films, Rukmini made sure to keep her Bollywood aspirations alive. So, in 2021, she made her Bollywood debut in 'Sanak' opposite Vidyut Jammwal. Later in Jammwal's 'Crakk' in 2023, she made a special appearance. It's been more than a year since Rukmini has shifted to Mumbai to

try her luck in Hindi films. In between, she appeared in Bengali films like 'Binodini', based on legendary Bengali theatre actress Binodini Dasi and 'Haati Haati Paa Paa'. Up next in Bengal, the actress would be seen opposite actor Dev in 'Bike Ambulance Dada'.

Meanwhile, producer Shah and Akshay go back a long way. They have worked together in films like 'Aankhen', 'Waqt: The Race Against Time', 'Namaste London' and 'Action Replayy'. Their last collaboration, 'Holiday: A Soldier Is Never Off Duty', was released in 2014. Reports suggest Shah has roped in Chris Peters, who has worked as an art director on 'Avengers: Domsday', for the Bollywood film.

MALAYALAM 'DAAYRA'

Parvathy Thiruvothu to make voice debut as Kareena's character

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, September 2

Popular Malayalam actress Parvathy Thiruvothu is all set to lend her voice to Kareena Kapoor Khan's character, Ajooni, in the Malayalam version of 'Daayra'. The collaboration marks Parvathy's foray into voice acting, adding a new dimension to her already celebrated body of work across Indian cinema. Parvathy made her Bollywood debut in 2017 opposite Irrfan Khan in the romantic comedy 'Qarib Qarib Singgle'.

KAREENA PLAYS DCP AJOOINI IN THE CRIME THRILLER

Inspired by true events, 'Daayra' is directed by National Award-winning filmmaker Meghna Gulzar. The film also stars Prithviraj Sukumaran in the lead role and is set to release in cinemas on September 18, 2026.

For Parvathy, the opportunity is particularly special as it marks the beginning of her journey into voice acting.

Known for choosing layered and challenging characters throughout her career, Parvathy brings her distinctive voice and performance sensibility to Ajooni, while staying true to the essence of Kareena's original portrayal.



UTTAM KUMAR'S BIRTH CENTENARY SPECIAL

UTTAM KUMAR'S HINDI FILM INDUSTRY TRYST: HITS, MISSES & WHAT-IFS

UTTAM KUMAR'S HINDI-FILM CAREER HAD STAR COLLABORATIONS BUT NEVER THE SUPERSTARDOM & SUCCESS HE ENJOINED IN BENGAL

ANINDITA ACHARYA
Kolkata, September 2

In the birth centenary year of Bengal's ultimate matinee idol, the West Bengal government has made elaborate arrangements to celebrate the one and only Uttam Kumar. But as the city decks itself up in the Mahanayak's charisma, on his 100th birth anniversary on Thursday, there is another side to the actor that many youngsters may not be aware of. For most Uttam fans, 'Nayak', 'Chowringhee', 'Antony Firingee', 'Jatugriha', 'Agnishwar', 'Sanyasi Raja' and of course, 'Saptapadi' remain legendary. Yet not many know that the Bengali matinee idol also acted in a Manmohan Desai film, 'Desh Premee', in 1982, alongside Amitabh Bachchan.

The film boasted an impressive cast, including Hema Malini, Sharmila Tagore, Premnath, Shammai Kapoor, Amjad Khan, Parikshit Sahni and Parveen Babi. However, Mohammed Rafi, who sang the title track of the film and Uttam had both passed away before the film was released. Actor Sudhir Dalvi lent his voice to Uttam in the film. Unfortunately, like several other Manmohan Desai-Amitabh collaborations, 'Desh Premee' didn't work wonders at the box office. Last year, Big B shared a photograph on social media with Uttam Kumar and captioned it: "Ek mahaan kala-ke saath... The great Uttam Kumar... Guru from Bengal... We worked together in DESH PREMEE... Together!"

It is said that when Bachchan met Uttam Kumar on the



IT WAS SHAKTI SAMANTA WHO EVENTUALLY GAVE UTTAM HIS MUCH-NEEDED SUCCESS IN HINDI CINEMA WITH 'AMANUSH' AND 'ANAND ASHRAM'

sets of the film, he touched his feet. Interestingly, Amitabh had started his career as an executive with a British managing agency in Kolkata before going on to become one of the biggest stars in Hindi cinema. Uttam, however, despite repeated attempts, could never replicate in Hindi films the kind of success and stardom he enjoyed in Bengal.

It is an irony that Agradoot's 'Agni Pariksha', one of the many Uttam-Suchitra blockbusters of 1954 in Bengali, didn't meet with the same success when Uttam produced its Hindi version. Adapted from Ashapurna Devi's novel of the same name, the story was first remade as a Telugu-Tamil bilingual in 1959. Uttam later decided to produce its Hindi version in 1967 as 'Chhoti Si Mulaqat'. Directed by Alo Sircar, the film featured Uttam and Vyjayanthimala as the romantic leads. But the film incurred huge losses for Uttam, leaving him almost bankrupt.

In fact, this remains a strange irony in Uttam Kumar's career. His blockbuster Bengali films, including 'Chhodobeshi' ('Chupke Chupke'), 'Deya Neya' ('Anurodh'), 'Bhranti Bilas' ('Angoor'), 'Nishipadma' ('Amar

Prem'), 'Uttarayan' ('Hum Dono') and 'Lal Pathor' ('Lal Pathar'), went on to become hits when remade in Hindi. Yet, when Uttam himself attempted to replicate that success with 'Chhoti Si Mulaqat', it backfired.

Many also believe that Uttam's Hindi-film sojourn could have been very different had he made his debut with Raj Kapoor's 'Sangam'. Raj Kapoor had offered Uttam the role that Rajendra Kumar eventually played. Uttam, however, at the height of his stardom, was unwilling to take what he perceived as the film's second lead. Uttam had earlier rejected an offer to play the lead in 'Jagte Raho'. The film, which starred Raj Kapoor, went on to become a major success overseas, riding on the Showman's overwhelming popularity. It was also produced in Bengali as 'Ek Din Raatre', with

Raj Kapoor, Chhabi Biswas, Pahari Sanyal, Nargis Dutt and Daisy Irani in the cast. Hemanta Mukherjee, the iconic composer-singer and one of Uttam's closest friends, also wanted to cast him in Bees Saal Baad opposite Waheeda Rehman. It is said that Uttam declined because he felt the heroine had greater prominence in the story.

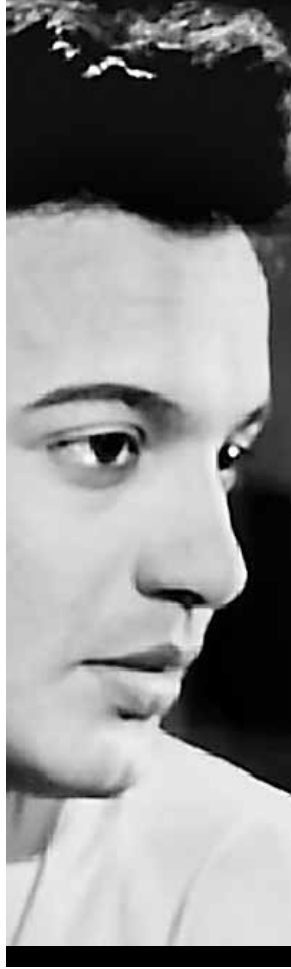
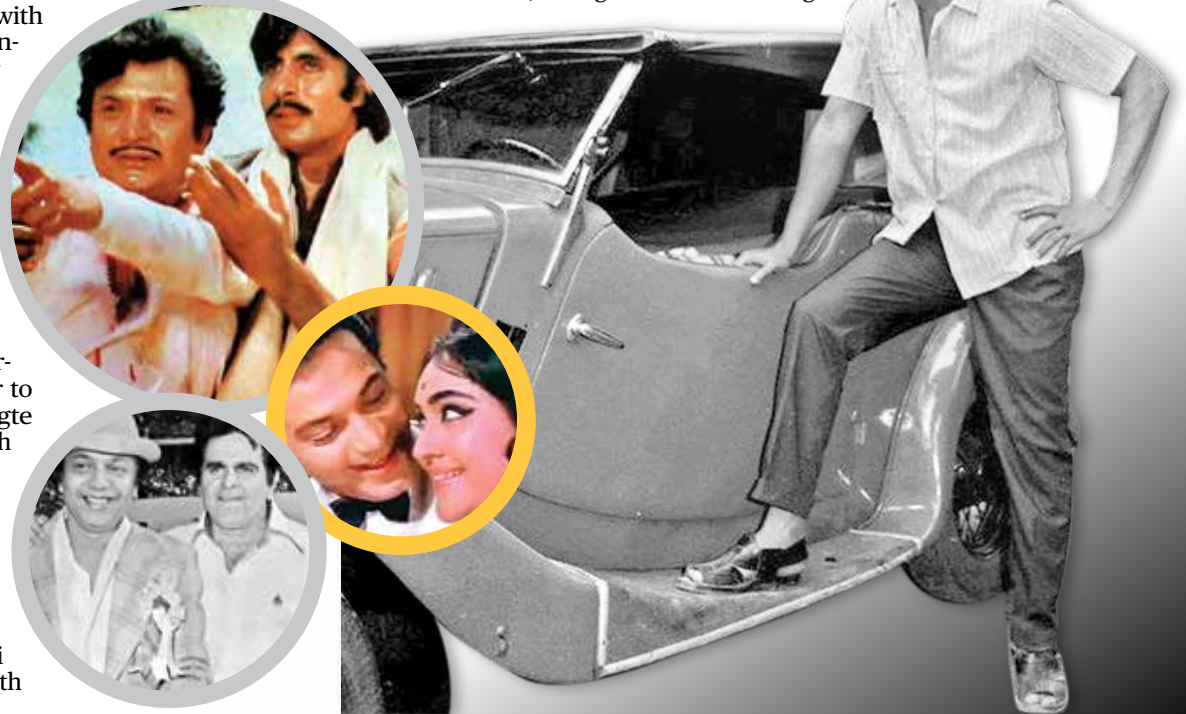
It was Shakti Samanta who eventually gave Uttam his much-needed success in Hindi cinema. With 'Amanush' (1975) and 'Anand Ashram' (1977), both starring Sharmila Tagore and made in Bengali and Hindi, Uttam finally found success in Bollywood. Yet even his admirers wouldn't necessarily consider these films to be representative of his best work.

Not many may know that Uttam also worked under the direction of Gulzar in 'Kitaab' in 1977. Based on Samaresh Basu's Bengali story Pathik, the film featured Vidya Sinha, Shreeram Lagoo and Asit Sen. In 1978, he went on to work in bilingual films such as 'Bandie' and 'Nishan'. Bhimsain, known as the Father of Indian Animation, directed Uttam in the 1979 Hindi film 'Dooriyan'. Sharmila was, once again, the obvious choice opposite the Bengali icon. 'Dooriyan', too, bombed at the box office.

Uttam is the darling of the masses in Bengal. He is the 'Mahanayak'. No actor in Bengal has been able to reach the stature he has achieved, even 46 years after his death. His status, acting charisma and range

remain unmatched.

Critics believe that had Uttam tried his luck in Hindi cinema earlier in his career, he might have struck gold. There's no denying his immense talent, his sheer range as an actor and his extraordinary command over his craft. But by the time Uttam (41) ventured seriously into Hindi cinema, greats such as Dilip Kumar, Dev Anand, Shammai Kapoor, Rajesh Khanna, Rajendra Kumar and later, Amitabh Bachchan and Dharmendra were already dominating the Hindi film landscape. And yet, none of that alters the larger truth. Uttam remains Bengal's king of hearts. And that truth remains untouched.



PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Manish Kaul @ Varun S/o Sh. Rajinder Pal R/o B-166, DLF Capital Green, Moti Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 172/2018 U/S 186/353/307/323/506 IPC, PS Kirti Nagar, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Manish Kaul @ Varun** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Manish Kaul @ Varun** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Manish Kaul @ Varun** of **FIR No. 172/2018 U/S 186/353/307/323/506 IPC, PS Kirti Nagar, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the date of **15.10.2026**.

By Order,
Sh. Shiv Kumar

Addl. Sessions Judge-02 (Fast Track Court)
West, Room No.324, Third Floor
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/12367/WD/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC/84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Md. Nesar Ahmed S/o Md. Attaurehman R/o 313/101 G, Tulsī Nagar, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **Case Reg. No. 9957/2019 U/S 138 NI Act, PS Keshavpuram, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Md. Nesar Ahmed** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Md. Nesar Ahmed** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Md. Nesar Ahmed** of **Case Reg. No. 9957/2019 U/S 138 NI Act, PS Keshavpuram, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the date of **05.02.2027**.

By Order,
Sh. Sanjam Jain

Judicial Magistrate First Class-04
North West, Room No.112, 1st Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/12167/NW/2026(Court Matter)

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Applications are invited under scheme of 'One Station One Product' for setting up

A. Total Thirteen (13) Stall at: Bahadurgarh, Delhi, Delhi Cantt, Delhi Shahdara, Ghaziabad, Gurgaon, Meerut Cantt, Meerut city, Patauli Road, Rohtak, Samalka, Shamli, Sonapat.

B. Total forty (40) Trolley at: Anand Vihar Terminal, Asawati, Baghpat Road, Ballabgarh, Baraut, Delhi Azadpur, Delhi Kishan Ganj, Delhi Safdarjung, Delhi Sakai Rohilla, Deoband, Faridabad, Faridabad New Town, Garhi Harsaru, Jakhai, Jind, Khatauli, Julana, Khekra, Mangolpuri, Mansa, Modinagar, Muradnagar, Nangoli, Narela, Narwana, Naya Ghaziabad, Noli, Okhla, Palam, Partapur, Sahibabad, Sakoti Tanda, Sampla, Shakurbasti, Shivaji Bridge, Tilak Bridge, Tonana, Tughlakabad, Vivek Vihar.

The period for setting up of stall/Trolley at Delhi Jn., Kurukshetra, Palwal, Gurgaon, & Meerut Cantt, Narela, Rohtak, Julana, Sampla Railway Stations per spell will be 90 days.

Registration fee for NSG 1, 2, 3 stations will be charged @ rate of Rs. 2000 for each spell of thirty days and for NSG 4,5,6 (Delhi Kishanganj, Deoband, Okhla, Shamli, Tapri, Jind, Jakhhal, Tonana, Mansa, Narwana, Baghpat Road, Khekra, Nangoli, Muradnagar, Khatauli, Meerut Cantt, Julana, Sampla, Shivaji Bridge, Tilak Bridge, Ganaur, Tughlakabad, Faridabad New Town, Ballabgarh, Palam., Delhi Safdarjung, Partapur & Sakoti Tanda Railway Station registration fee will be charged @ rate of Rs. 1000 for each spell of thirty days.

The following are the eligibility criteria for participant viz

a) Holder of Artisans/Weaver ID card issued by Development Commissioner Handicraft, Development Commissioner Handloom, or by the requisite state/Central Government Authority.

b) Individual artisans/weavers/craftsmen enrolled/registered with Tribal Cooperative Marketing Development Federation of India Limited (TRIFED)/National Handloom Development Corporation (NHDC)/Khadi/Village Industries Commission (KVIC)/associated with Social Organizations, State Govt. bodies and associated with registered micro enterprises on the Udyam Portal of the Ministry of MSME and NGOs etc.

c) Self Help Groups registered with PMEGP (Prime Minister's Employment Generation Programme).

d) Marginalized or weaker sections of society.

e) No separate logo shall be allowed.

The applicant will have to submit an undertaking to the Station Superintendent indicating that no activity would be undertaken to adversely affect the train operations, passenger safety and image of the Railways.

Applications should be addressed and can be submitted to Station Superintendent at station by the applicant till 15:00 hrs. of 08.09.2026, which will be opened on same day.

Station Superintendent will make priority roster of all approved participants and priority will be established through a draw of lots conducted at the station in the presence of all approved applicants by the Station Manager/Sectional CMI and nominated Finance representative.

The One Station One Product scheme shall be governed by Railway Board's Commercial Circular No. 12 of 2022 and 09 of 2023 respectively available at Website: www.indianrailways.gov.in & URL: https://indianrailways.gov.in/railwayboard/uploads/directorate/traffic_comm/Comm_Cir_2022/OSOP%20Policy.pdf & https://indianrailways.gov.in/railwayboard/uploads/directorate/traffic_comm/Comm_Cir_2023/CC%20%2009%20of%202023.pdf For any queries applicant may contact Station Superintendent or CMI of the respective stations.

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 3025/26

GOVERNMENT OF PUNJAB
PUNJAB URBAN PLANNING & DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
PUDA Complex, Urban Estate Phase-II, Patiala

E-Tender No. 180/PUDA/DE(Civil)2026/19153 dated 02-09-2026
Divisional Engineer (Civil), PUDA, Patiala invites online bids for "Development work at 2.95 acre EWS Site in Animal Husbandry Site (PUDA Enclave-I) at Patiala (DNIT Amount -Rs. 137.35 Lacs.)"

Closing date & time: 14-09-2026 at 01.00 PM

For details log on to: <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>

NOTE: Any corrigendum(s) to the tender notice shall be published on the above website only

PR-Advt. No :- 1716/12/2026-27/14808

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Virender Kumar S/o Mohar Singh R/o H. No. 184, Gali No. 02, Shiv Mandir Wali Gali, (Lal Mandir) Nehru Vihar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case **CC NI Act No. 382/2021, U/s 138 NI Act, PS Nand Nagri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Virender Kumar** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Virender Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Virender Kumar** of Case **CC NI Act No. 382/2021, U/s 138 NI Act, PS Nand Nagri, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **12.10.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Rahul Saini

Judicial Magistrate First Class-08
Room No. G-6, New Court Building
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/12007/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),email-
sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely **Birbal S/O Bachan Ram R/O Jaipur A/P Narwal Bala** is evading his arrest/wanted in case **FIR No. 239/1990 U/S 379 RPC**, of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name : Birbal

S/O : Bachan Ram

Address : Jaipur A/P Narwal Bala

Age : 60-65 Years

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1.DPO, Jammu : 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578

2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

3.PCR Jammu : 0191-2605949

4.SP City South : 0191-2430002

5.SDPO City East : 0191 2433778

6.P/S Bahu Fort : 0191-2475133

Sd/-
Superintendent of Police
Jammu

DIP No:DP/J-9302/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Bablu @ Narender @ Deepak, S/o Nathu Ram @ Kalu Ram, R/o 1) MSC-112, Yogmaya Multani Dhandra, NABI KARIM, Delhi, 2) H.No. 9660, Gali No. 11, Multani Dhandra, Paharganj, Delhi, 3) A-56, Gali No. 8, Pratap Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 138/2020, U/s 356/379/411 IPC, P.S. NABI KARIM, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Bablu @ Narender @ Deepak** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Bablu @ Narender @ Deepak** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Bablu @ Narender @ Deepak** accused of **FIR No. 138/2020, U/s 356/379/411 IPC, P.S. NABI KARIM, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.10.2026**.

By Order - Ms. Nidhi Bala

Judicial Magistrate First Class-05, Central
Room No. 241, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/12413/CD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr. P.C.

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Vijay Kumar S/o Chander Pal R/o 36/2B, Sec-02, Riz Area, Gole Market, New Delhi**, have committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence under **FIR No. 218/2019 U/s 323/324/336/341/506/34 IPC.**, has been registered at **PS: Mandawali, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Vijay Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Vijay Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Vijay Kumar** of under has been under **FIR No. 218/2019 U/s 323/324/336/341/506/34 IPC.**, registered at **PS: Mandawali, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.10.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Sachin

JMFC-03 (East), Room No.16
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/12037/ED/2026
(Court notice)

UJVN Limited

(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)

H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No.U40101UR2001SGC025866, Website:www.ujvnl.com

फोन नं० 758 दिनांक: 02/09/2026

TENDER NOTICE

The office of Executive Engineer (Test), Maneri Bhali Stage-II, Chinyalisaur (Uttarkashi) invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tenders is given below:-
Tender No: NIT No: 06/EE (Test)/MB-II/2026-27
Name of work / Supply/Services: Synchronization of ICT Devices in Isolated OT Networks with GPS-Based NTP Server at Dharasu Power House MB-II, Chinyalisaur Uttarkashi.
Estimated cost: Rs.647000.00/- Only (Taxes extra)
Date of availability of bid document on website: - 05.09.2026
Last date for submission of tender: - 28.09.2026 up to 11:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "www.ujvnl.com"

Executive Engineer (Test)

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

POWERGRID RAMGARH TRANSMISSION LIMITED

(100% Subsidiary of POWERGRID Corporation of India Ltd)

Registered Office: B-9, Qutab Institutional Area, Katwaria Sarai, New Delhi-110016

NOTICE

1. The Petitioner above-named has filed a petition before the Central Electricity Regulatory Commission, New Delhi for determination of Tariff from Proposed DOCO to 31-03-2029 for **Project-1:** "Transmission system for evacuation of power from REZ in Rajasthan (20 GW) under Phase-III Part E2".

2. The beneficiaries of the Transmission system are: (a) Ajmer Vidhyut Vitran Nigam Ltd. (b) Jaipur Vidhyut Vitran Nigam Ltd. (c) Jodhpur Vidhyut Vitran Nigam Ltd. (d) Punjab State Electricity Corporation Limited (e) Haryana Power Purchase Centre (f) Jammu & Kashmir Power Corporation Ltd. (g) Uttar Pradesh Power Corporation Ltd. (h) BSES Yamuna Power Ltd. (i) BSES Rajdhani Power Ltd. (j) Tata Power Delhi Distribution Ltd. (k) Chandigarh Electricity department (l) Uttarakhand Power Corporation Ltd. (m) North Central Railway (n) New Delhi Municipal Council (o) Himachal Pradesh State Electricity Board (p) Central Transmission Utility of India Ltd. (q) Beawar transmission Ltd. & Fatehgarh-III Beawar transmission Ltd.

3. Capacity of the transformer, number of bays of the transmission system:

Project	Transformer Capacity (MVA)	No. of Bays		
		765 kV	400 kV	220 kV
Phase-III Part E2	1x1500	1	1	0

4. Approved capital cost of the project (Rs. in lakh) - **Project-1: Rs. 428.30 Crores**

5. Capital cost on the date of commercial operation (Rs. in lakhs):

Asset	Asset Name	Approved Capital Cost of the Project	
		FR	Actual
Project-1: "Transmission system for evacuation of power from REZ in Rajasthan (20 GW) under Phase-III Part E2"			
Asset-1	1x1500 MVA, 765/400 kV, ICT-6 along with associated bays at Fatehgarh-III Substation	11124.40	11144.43

Authority which has approved the Capital Cost: Board of Directors

6. Scheduled date of Commercial Operation and Actual date of Commercial Operation:

Project Name	SCOD	COD
Project-1: Transmission system for evacuation of power from REZ in Rajasthan (20 GW) under Phase-III Part E2"	Asset-1: 30.06.2025 Or evacuation requirement beyond 3000 MW cumulative at Fatehgarh-3 (new section) & Fatehgarh-4 PS, whichever is later	Asset-1: 01.06.2026 (Proposed)

7. Details of tariff (Publish only applicable portion): (Rs. in lakhs)

Assets	2024-25	2025-26	2026-27	2027-28	2028-29
Project-1:					
Asset-1	0.00	0.00	1525.65	1978.24	2040.29

A copy of the petition made for determination of tariff is posted on the website <https://apps.powergrid.in/ncrc/docs/TBCC-PRTL/2026/08/>

8. The suggestions and objections, if any, on the proposals for determination of tariff contained in the petition may be filed by any person, including the beneficiary through the e-filing portal of the Commission, with a copy to the Petitioner within 30 days of publication of this notice.

Place: Gurugram
Date: 02.09.2026

Sd/
Shri Rajesh Kumar Sharma
Project In-charge

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),email-
sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely **Abdul Ghani S/O Abdul Rehman R/O Annatnag, Driver of Truck Bearing Registration No. JK01-0339** is evading his arrest/ wanted in case **FIR No. 99/1994 U/S 279/337 RPC**, of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name : Abdul Ghani

S/O : Abdul Rehman

Address : Annatnag

Age : 60-65 Years

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1.DPO, Jammu : 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578

2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

3.PCR Jammu : 0191-2605949

4.SP City South : 0191-2430002

5.SDPO City East : 0191 2433778

6.P/S Bahu Fort : 0191-2475133

Sd/-
Superintendent of Police
Jammu

DIP No:DP/J-9304/26

PUBLIC NOTICE

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Ltd. Office Number 201-B, 2nd Floor, Road No. 1 Plot No. B3, WIPIT Park, Wagle Industrial Estate, Thane (West)- 400604.

The following borrower(s) has/have defaulted in the repayment of principal and interest towards the Loan facility(ies) availed from ICICI Bank. The Loan(s) has/have been classified as Non-Performing Asset(s) (NPA). A Notice was issued to them under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, at their last known addresses. However, it has not been served and are therefore being notified by way of this Public Notice.

Sr.	Name of the Borrower/ Co-Borrower/ Guarantor/ (Loan Account Number) & Address	Description of Secured Asset to be enforced	Date of Notice sent/ Outstanding as on Date of Notice	NPA Date
1.	Hemant Kumar/ Parul Dawar/ (LBGUR000005843173)/ 602, Tower 1, Vipul Lavanya Sector 81, Nawada Fatehpur, Gurgaon- 122004	Flat No. 702, 7th Floor, Wing-A-2, Lalwani Vastu, Plot Nos. 63,64,65,66,67,68 And 69, Survey No. 232 Hissa No. 1+2, Sakore Nagar Co.Op.Housing Society, Village- Lohegaon, Taluka- Haveli, Pune- 411014/ Adm. Approximately About 1105 Sq.ft. Le. 102.65 Mtrs In Built Up Area Along With The Terrace Adm. 130 Sq.ft. Le. 12.07 Sq.mtrs Along With Covered Car Parking Space Bearing No. 54A+54B Under Stilts of The Building Wing "A"	August 07, 2026 Rs. 8,03,478.5/-	03/ June/ 2026

These steps are being taken for substituted service of Notice. The above borrower/s (as applicable) is/are advised to make the outstanding payment within 60 days from the date of publishing this Notice. Else, further steps will be taken as per the provisions of the Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002.

Date: September 03, 2026
Place: Gurgaon

Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

APPENDIX IV-A

Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Property

E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) and Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to **Sammaan Capital Limited** (formerly known as **Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.**) [CIN : L65922DL2005PLC136029] ("Secured Creditor"), the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on **22.09.2026** from **05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M.**, for recovery of **Rs. 18,00,635/- (Rupees Eighteen Lakh Six Hundred Thirty Five only)** pending towards **Loan Account No. HHLDP00206160**, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till **24.08.2026** with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w. e. f. **25.08.2026** along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from **PRADEEP KUMAR and RAJIV RANJAN KUMAR (GUARANTOR)**.

The Reserve Price of the Immovable Property will be **Rs. 8,65,000/- (Rupees Eight Lakh Sixty Five Thousand only)** and the Earnest Money Deposit ("EMD") will be **Rs. 86,500/- (Rupees Eighty Six Thousand Five Hundred only)** i. e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

FLAT NO. FF - 3 (L. I. G.), HAVING AREA 400 SQUARE FEET EQUIVALENT TO 37.16 SQUARE METERS ON FIRST FLOOR, REAR R. H. S. CONSTRUCTED UPON PLOT NO. A - 144, KHASRA NO. 392, SFL VED VIHAR, LONI, GHAZIABAD -200111, UTTAR PRADESH.

For detailed terms and conditions of sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i.e. www.sammaancapital.com; Contact No : 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024; E-mail id : auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com. For bidding, log on to www.auctionfocus.in.

Sd/-
AUTHORISED OFFICER
SAMMAAN CAPITAL LIMITED
(Formerly known as
INDIABULLS HOUSING FINANCE LTD.)

Date : 25.08.2026
Place : GHAZIABAD

APPENDIX IV-A

Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Property

E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) and Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to **Sammaan Capital Limited** (formerly known as **Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.**) [CIN : L65922DL2005PLC136029] ("Secured Creditor"), the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on **22.09.2026** from **05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M.**, for recovery of **Rs. 17,70,116/- (Rupees Seventeen Lakh Seventy Thousand One Hundred Sixteen only)** pending towards **Loan Account No. HHLDCP00289143**, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till **24.08.2026** with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w. e. f. **25.08.2026** along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from **BINOD KUMAR KESHARI @ VINOD KUMAR KESHARI and AMRITA KESHRI**.

The Reserve Price of the Immovable Property will be **Rs. 7,30,000/- (Rupees Seven Lakh Thirty Thousand only)** and the Earnest Money Deposit ("EMD") will be **Rs. 73,000/- (Rupees Seventy Three Thousand only)** i. e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

ONE RESIDENTIAL FLAT BEARING NO. - GF - 03, L.I. G. FLATS, HAVING 375 SQ. FT. EQUIVALENT TO 34.84 SQ. MTR. OF TOTAL COVERED AREA ON GROUND FLOOR, REAR RIGHT HAND SIDE, WITHOUT ROOF RIGHTS, CONSTRUCTED ON PLOT BEARING NO. - 9, IN BLOCK - E, 'SFL VED VIHAR', VILLAGE SADULLABAD, TEHSIL LONI GHAZIABAD -201102, UTTAR PRADESH.

THE SAID FLAT IS BOUNDED AS:

WEST : COMMON PASSAGE
EAST : OTHERS' LAND
NORTH : FLAT NO. G. F. - 1 (M. I. G.)
SOUTH : OTHERS' LAND

For detailed terms and conditions of sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i.e. www.sammaancapital.com; Contact No : 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024; E-mail id : auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com. For bidding, log on to www.auctionfocus.in.

Sd/-
AUTHORISED OFFICER
SAMMAAN CAPITAL LIMITED
(Formerly known as
INDIABULLS HOUSING FINANCE LTD.)

Date : 25.08.2026
Place : GHAZIABAD

APPENDIX IV-A

Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Property

E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) and Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to **India SME Asset Reconstruction Company Limited** [CIN : U67190MH2008PLC181062] ("Secured Creditor"), the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on **22.09.2026** from **05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M.**, for recovery of **Rs. 28,78,399/- (Rupees Twenty Eight Lakh Seventy Eight Thousand Three Hundred Nine only)** pending towards **Loan Account No. HHLNOD00417846**, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till **10.08.2026** with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w. e. f. **11.08.2026** along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from **TEENA GOSWAMI and TARUN GOSWAMY**.

The Loan Account bearing No. **HHLNOD00417846**, along with all right(s), title(s), interest(s), underlying security(ies), pledge(s) and / or guarantee(s), including the Immovable Property, has been assigned by **Sammaan Capital Limited ("SCL")** (formerly known as **Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.**) to and in favour of the Secured Creditor acting as a **Trustee of ISARC - 2025-2026-5 Trust** vide Assignment Agreement dated **26.12.2025**. The Secured Creditor has duly taken over the financial facility from SCL and is thus, vested with all powers and related to recover its outstanding dues in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) and / or enforcement of security interest in relation to the Immovable Property.

The Reserve Price for the Immovable Property will be **Rs. 51,75,000/- (Rupees Fifty One Lakh Seventy Five Thousand only)** and the Earnest Money Deposit ("EMD") will be **Rs. 5,17,500/- (Rupees Five Lakh Seventeen Thousand Five Hundred only)** i. e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

UNIT NO. SUN 2 - 1605, 16TH FLOOR, TOWER - SUN 2, MIGSUN WYNN, AT PLOT NO. GH - 01B (1A) - ETA - 2, GREATER NOIDA, GAUTAM BUDDHA NAGAR, UTTAR PRADESH - 201308.

For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i.e. www.isarc.in; Helpline No : 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024; E - mail id : auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com For bidding, log on to www.auctionfocus.in.

Sd/-
AUTHORISED OFFICER
INDIA SME ASSET RECONSTRUCTION COMPANY LIMITED
Trustee of ISARC - 2025-2026-5 Trust

Date : 25.08.2026
Place : GAUTAM BUDDHA NAGAR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Shahid, S/o: Rafiq, R/o: F-89, Gali No. 09, Khajuri Khas, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 736/2022, U/s: 392/34 IPC, Police Station Shastri Park, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Shahid** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Shahid** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Shahid** of **Police Station Shastri Park, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.12.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Norma Jain

Ld. JMFC-03, North-East,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/12092/NE/2026

DELHI TRANSCO LIMITED

NOTICE INVITING e-TENDERS

Delhi Transco Ltd, a Government of NCT of Delhi Undertaking, invites online tender for the work :

Tender No. T26P750016: Construction of boundary wall along with internal grid roads at 220 KV substations IP.

For complete details of the tender please visit following websites :- <https://govtprocurement.delhi.gov.in> (Tender ID No. 2026_DTL_297544_1) and www.dtl.gov.in with Unique No. DTL-0153-270826

Last date for bid submission:- 30.09.2026, at 13.00 Hrs.

All Corrigendum/Addendum/ Amendments/Date of Extension/ Clarifications etc. to this e-tender will be hosted on the above website only. Bidders should regularly visit website to keep themselves updated.



AROUND THE WORLD

- » PM Narendra Modi will visit Delhi's SRCC on September 5 as Chief Guest at a campus
- » NIT Rourkela received 1,340 offers in 2025–26 placement drive
- » The number of graduate jobs in UK has fallen nearly 50% in one year
- » Classes 10th to 12th revised NCERT textbooks being prepared in mission mode: Minister
- » University of London, Northeastern University to establish offshore campuses in Hyderabad: Telangana CM



BUZZER ROUND

Q) Who was the first human to travel to space?

Send us your replies to careersmp22@gmail.com. We shall publish the names of the first 3 correct entries in next week's edition

Answer to our Aug 27 edition question: **Sabu Dastagir**

Correct answers were sent by: **Aritra Majumdar, Pallavi Bhattacharya, Ruan Talukdar**



NEWS & VIEWS

Comptroller and Auditor General of India (CAG) and IIT Madras are launching a Certification programme on Audit of Digital Systems (CADS). This is a first-of-its-kind certification programme curated by any Supreme Audit Institution to build capacity in auditing digital government and enterprise systems.

Indian School of Hospitality is expanding its campus at INXT City Centre, Gurugram, nearly doubling its existing footprint as the institution enters its next phase of growth. Capacity will grow from around 550 students to approximately 1,200.

HIRING IN AI ERA

AI IS CHANGING JOBS, SKILLS BECOME THE DIFFERENTIATOR

Upskilling and redeployment emerge as key challenges in the evolving job market

ANINDITA ACHARYA

One lakh seventy-five thousand (1,75,000). Wondering what this figure is all about? Well, this is the number of technology workers who have lost their jobs globally in 2026 so far. And we still have four months before we enter 2027. Do you know how many tech workers lost their jobs in 2025? 245,000.

Of course, Artificial Intelligence (AI) is one of the primary reasons behind these job cuts. But beyond AI adoption and automation, companies are also restructuring and cutting costs. From Apple, Oracle, Microsoft, Uber and Amazon to Google, Salesforce, LinkedIn, Meta, Cisco and PayPal, the job cuts have not only affected the technology sector but have also impacted real estate, manufacturing, retail, recruitment, crypto, aerospace and transportation. But let's understand the larger picture. There is little point in lamenting any further about how and why AI is reshaping jobs across industries. The reality is that AI is transforming recruitment and shifting demand away from routine jobs towards specialised skills.

AI literacy is no longer optional if you want to stay afloat in the job market. And that does not simply mean knowing how to write prompts on ChatGPT or Claude. You must know how to explore AI-generated data, spot patterns and draw actionable conclusions. Knowing how to integrate AI tools is equally important, connecting



multiple AI platforms and systems to create seamless workflows that can solve complex problems. "AI literacy will become a foundational skill across almost every profession. There will always be specialist roles involving machine learning, data science and AI engineering. But for the broader workforce, the ability to effectively use generative AI tools will increasingly become a mainstream workplace skill, much like using spreadsheets or presentation software today," said Kartik Narayan, CEO, Apna.

According to Swapnil Sahoo, Great Lakes Institute of Manage-

ment, Gurgaon, the most valuable young professional will be someone who can use AI to complete the first 60-70% of a task quickly, but then knows how to question the output. "India had an estimated 600,000-650,000 AI professionals in 2024, but NASSCOM estimates that the country will require more than 1.25 million by 2027. Don't become only a 'prompt engineer.' Become an AI-enabled finance professional, marketer, strategist, product manager, engineer, researcher or entrepreneur. Technology plus domain expertise is much more defensible than technology alone," he said.

Microsoft co-founder Bill Gates has warned that AI could lead to massive unemployment. But Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang has argued that the technology will also create a huge number of new jobs. "Everybody's job changes. Some jobs will be eliminated. Many new jobs will be created," he said.

In a report, Boston Consulting

Group said that over the next two to three years, 50% to 55% of jobs in the USA will be reshaped by AI. It also mentioned that while job augmentation and new job creation will happen rapidly, the full substitution of jobs by AI will be slower. The report said the key challenge in the AI era will not simply be the number of jobs affected, but how quickly workers can be upskilled and redeployed into redesigned roles. "In 2026, companies have moved or are moving away from degree-centric hiring to competency-based models. Graduates must demonstrate applied skills, adaptability, and agility. Companies want talent that can navigate AI-driven workflows, collaborate across borders, and deliver measurable outcomes. India will remain a strong growth hub, especially in technology, green energy, and advanced manufacturing, but hiring will be selective. The differentiator will be wider exposure—graduates who have experienced exchange programmes, interdisciplinary learning modules, and cross-cultural projects will stand out in a market that values diversity and global mindset," said Vishal Khurma of Woxsen University, Hyderabad.

AI WILL BE PART OF MOST ROLES GOING FORWARD. THE CHALLENGE IS DETERMINING WHETHER CANDIDATES CAN THINK INDEPENDENTLY WHILE USING IT

STUDENTS FROM TIER 2 AND TIER 3 INDIAN CITIES DRIVE STUDY ABROAD BOOM

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Most conversations about studying abroad centre on ambition, prestige, and opportunity. What rarely gets told is who actually carries the heaviest financial risk when that dream is threatened. It is not the wealthy. It is about a student from a smaller town, from a humble background, with a family that has spent years quietly saving for a single shot at a different life.

While students from well-off families are certainly part of the picture, the overwhelming majority of students funded come from small towns and lower income backgrounds. "If you look at our data itself, you will find that students from tier 2 and tier 3 cities make up nearly 79% of the students we serve. But, this trend is not unique to India. We see the exact same pattern in Brazil and across the Africa region. Most of these students come from a very humble background," said Sonal Kapoor, Global Chief Business Officer at Prodigy Finance.

One story captures this reality with striking clarity. A student whose father is a farmer said that going to a traditional bank for a loan was simply not possible,



because the only asset his family had was the land they farmed, and by law, agricultural land in India cannot be used as collateral. Farmer income is also tax exempt, which meant he could not even produce the tax returns most lenders required. His entire path to a master's degree existed only because a lender was willing to look past what his family did not have, and see what he was capable of instead. The same story plays out an ocean away. A student from a small town in southern Brazil, the first in his entire family to ever pursue a degree abroad, went on to work at an investment banking in

New York and eventually became Chief of Staff at a major food retail company, a career path he said would have taken 10 to 15 years longer without that first loan.

If you look at the ground reality of what the average farming household in India actually earns, according to Indian Council for Research on International Economic Relations (ICRIER), the figure sits at roughly Rs 19,696 a month, with many earning even less than this. Against that backdrop, funding an international

master's degree is not just ambitious. It borders on impossible, unless someone is willing to lend against a future that has not happened yet, rather than a past that never had the means.

Visa restrictions and currency fluctuations usually hit these students the hardest, precisely because they have the least cushion to absorb any shock. For families with this income, the dream is rarely something big. Sometimes that push comes from just being able to walk into a shop and not look at the price tag first. Or sit down for a meal together without quietly doing the maths in your head. To a middle class or wealthy family, that probably sounds trivial. But for a family that has never had that, it can feel like a completely different life. One they never even let themselves imagine.

For many, studying abroad genuinely delivers that transformation. 74% of graduates at least double their salary after their master's, a figure that climbs to nearly 80% among students from low-income countries, with more than half quadrupling it.

THIS TREND IS NOT UNIQUE TO INDIA. THE EXACT SAME PATTERN CAN BE WITNESSED IN BRAZIL AND ACROSS THE AFRICA REGION

Admission alert



ACCELERATED GENERAL MANAGEMENT PROGRAMME FROM IIM AHMEDABAD

OUR CORRESPONDENT

IIM Ahmedabad has opened admissions for the 19th batch of its Accelerated General Management Programme (AGMP), a one-year blended learning programme designed for working professionals seeking to broaden their business perspective and prepare for larger leadership responsibilities. The programme is in collaboration with Jaro Education.

Designed for mid and senior-level professionals, the programme provides participants with a holistic understanding of general management by integrating disciplines such as strategy, finance, economics, marketing, operations, leadership, technology, and innovation into a single business perspective.

The programme is intended for graduates with at least five years of work experience, who aspire to transition into broader business leadership roles. Beyond academic learning, participants also have the opportunity to build long-term professional networks through interactions with accomplished peers and distinguished IIMA faculty. Eligible participants who successfully complete the programme receive a Certificate of Completion from IIM Ahmedabad and may qualify for IIMA Alumni Status, subject to the programme's evaluation criteria and requirements.

Know the details

- Duration:** One year
Mode of delivery: Blended Learning (Interactive online sessions with three on-campus modules at IIM Ahmedabad)
Eligibility:
» Graduate in any discipline with a minimum of 50% marks
» Minimum 5 years of work experience

Trending COURSES

Blended MBA & EFPM from IIM Lucknow

OUR CORRESPONDENT

IIM Lucknow inaugurated the second batch of its Blended MBA Programme (2026–28) and the Executive Fellow Programme in Management (EFPM) at the campus recently. Addressing the new batch, Prof MP Gupta, Director, IIM Lucknow, mentioned that the landscape of management education is changing, with programmes designed specifically for working professionals gaining increasing relevance. Conventional full-time programmes can be challenging for professionals to pursue alongside their careers, making flexible formats such as blended and executive education increasingly important. These programmes provide professionals with the opportunity to continue working while upgrading their knowledge, developing new capabilities, and staying relevant in a rapidly changing professional environment.

The growing demand for flexible management education reflects a broader shift towards learning formats that enable professionals to balance academic pursuits with their careers. Programmes such as the Blended MBA provide an opportunity to integrate classroom learning with workplace experience, while the EFPM offers experienced professionals and management practitioners a pathway to engage in advanced research and contribute to management knowledge.

The programme also included a session on "Learning through Case Studies," focusing on the practical application of management concepts and experiential learning.

BLACKBOARD

IIT Guwahati recently celebrated its 33rd Foundation Day event and Assam CM Dr Himanta Biswa Sarma was present as the chief guest. As part of the Foundation Day celebrations, the institute organized an 'Open House' and welcomed over 750 students from nine schools and colleges across the region.

IIT Madras is partnering with UNESCO Mahatma Gandhi Institute of Education for Peace and Sustainable Development (UNESCO MGIEP) to develop next-generation AI and immersive learning technologies aimed at transforming education globally. The collaboration will combine UNESCO MGIEP's global leadership in Social and Emotional Learning (SEL) with IIT Madras' expertise in AI, Extended Reality (XR), game design and immersive technologies to create digital learning solutions that make education more engaging, interactive and learner-centric.

The Xavier's University Debating Society (XUDS) organised XAV-MUN 2026, a two-day Model United Nations conference at St. Xavier's University, Kolkata recently. The conference brought together students from various schools and colleges to deliberate on contemporary national and international issues through simulated diplomatic and parliamentary forums.